



Groundbreaking Ceremony of Advanced System In Package Technologies OSAT Facility by

Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

HIGHLIGHTS

- With an investment of over ₹460 cr, ASIP is Andhra Pradesh's and South India's first semiconductor manufacturing project approved under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM), marking a significant step towards strengthening India's advanced semiconductor packaging ecosystem.
- APACK Co, South Korea as its technology partner.
- Production Capacity of 96 Mn chips per year.
- Advanced semiconductor packaging for AI, high-performance computing, Data centres, and high-speed communications.
- 1000+ direct high-skilled and 1600+ indirect job creation, enabling skill development, supply chain localization and ecosystem growth.
- ASIP also envisions the future expansion of its 30 acre facility with an additional investment of over ₹ 2000 cr for Advanced Semiconductor Packaging.

In the august presence of

Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw
Hon'ble Union Minister for Railways, Information & Broadcasting and Electronics & Information Technology

Shri Nara Chandrababu Naidu
Hon'ble Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh

Shri Nara Lokesh
Hon'ble Minister for Electronics & IT,
Andhra Pradesh

1st August 2026, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh

Welcome by
Shri Venkata Simhadri
MD & CEO, ASIP TECHNOLOGIES

Watch Live at DD News



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Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority



MEGA E-AUCTION

GOLDEN OPPORTUNITY TO GET PLOT IN INDUSTRIAL AREA

Allotment through E-Auction

INDUSTRIAL PLOTS

- AMETHI •BANDA •JHANSI •HAPUR •JALAUN
- ETAH •HARDOI •MATHURA •FATEHPUR
- VARANASI •HAMIRPUR •MAINPURI
- SAHARANPUR BARABANKI •MUZAFAR NAGAR

FLATTED FACTORY- SURAJPUR

WAREHOUSING PLOTS : BARABANKI, PRAYAGRAJ

COMMERCIAL PLOTS

MULTIPLEX: Prayagraj

WORKING WOMEN HOSTEL: TGC-Unnao

CLUB: TGC-Unnao, TDS City-Ghaziabad

OFFICE/BPO: TGC-Unnao

SCHOOL: Hardoi, TGC-Unnao, Barabanki, TDS City-Ghaziabad

GROUP HOUSING: Barabanki, Hamirpur, TGC-Unnao, Prayagraj, TDS City-Ghaziabad

HOTEL: TGC-Unnao, Prayagraj

PETROL PUMP/CNG FILLING STATION CUM SERVICE CENTRE: Prayagraj, TGC-Unnao

WORKSHOP/SERVICE STATION: Amethi

HOSPITAL/NURSING HOME/DISPENSARY: Prayagraj, TGC-Unnao, TDS City-Ghaziabad

COMMUNITY CENTRE: TGC-Unnao

WEIGH BRIDGE: TGC-Unnao

BANQUET HALL/ MULTIPURPOSE HALL-2 (BARATGHAR): TGC-Unnao, TDS City Ghaziabad

SHOPPING CENTRE: Hamirpur, Hapur

Registration and Document Download Begins : 01.08.2026, 10:00 AM

Last date for submission of Catalogue, Processing Fee & EMD by bidder: 20.08.2026, 06:00 PM

Last date for Final Online Documents Submission : 21.08.2026, 06:00 PM

Online E-Bidding Starts : 25.08.2026, 10:00 AM to 01:00 PM

Industrial Plots are also available for allotment on 'Nivesh Mitra Portal'

Note : For registration & Other details please visit Auction Portal <https://upsida.project247.in>

For Information regarding the registration & e-auction process -

HELPLINE NO.
Vasu Patel-9510974587
(Monday to Friday 10:00 AM to 7:00 PM and 1st & 3rd Saturday 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM)

CONTACT ON EMAIL:
eauction@upsida.co.in
vasu.patel@procure247.com

Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority

UPSIDA Complex A 1/4 Lakhnapur, Kanpur-208024



TAMIL NADU CONSUMERS' CO-OPERATIVE FEDERATION LTD.
29/2, Arcot Road, Saligramam, Chennai - 600093
Email ID: tanco93@yahoo.com & tnccf@tn.gov.in

E-Tender Notice
E-Tender No: TNCCF/2026-27/04 DATE: 30.07.2026

Tamil Nadu Consumers Cooperative Federation invites all India online electronic tender for "Purchase of 1000 Metric Tons of Double Roasted Rava in 1 kg Packets, 1000 Metric Tons of Samba Rava in 1 kg Packets and 1100 Metric Tons of Semiya (Vermicelli) in 200 Grams Packet" for **The Perumthalaivar Kamarajar Breakfast Scheme**. Complete e-tender document can be viewed and downloaded through <https://tntenders.gov.in> and also available in nigceppapp free of cost from **01.08.2026, 10.00 A.M onwards**. The bidders have to participate online bidding only with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-III.

Last Date and Time for Online Submission : **01.09.2026 Upto 12.30 P.M.**

DIPR/2422/TENDER/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**



UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR

OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION R.S.PURA

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No. DRSP/57 of 2026-27 Dated 28-07-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on **percentage** basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (in Lacs)	Cost of document (in Rs)	Earnest Money (in Rs)	Time Allowed for complete -on	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	Maintenance/General Upkeeping of road from Kullian to Suchetgarh via RS Pura during the year 2026-27 upto ending March 2027 (BT) (Under Non Plan)	PWD (R&B) Division R.S.Pura	4.97	600	2% of the Advertised Cost	Ending March 2027	(1300 Hrs) on or after 06-08-2026	"A", "B", "C" & "D" Class
2	Maintenance/General Upkeeping of road from Kullian to Suchetgarh via RS Pura during the year 2026-27 upto ending March 2027 (Drain Work) (Under Non Plan)	PWD (R&B) Division R.S.Pura	4.99	600	2% of the Advertised Cost	Ending March 2027	(1300 Hrs) on or after 06-08-2026	"A", "B", "C" & "D" Class
3	Construction of main road Sher chak to Aik Nallah (Under District Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division R.S.Pura	50.00	1500	2% of the Advertised Cost	04 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 06-08-2026	"A" & "B" Class
4	Widening/Upgradation of road from Trewa to Sai Tangali at RD 1/00-2/200 (Under District Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division R.S.Pura	50.00	1500	2% of the Advertised Cost	04 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 06-08-2026	"A" & "B" Class

Position of AAA :- S.No. 1, 2 Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD(R&B) Circle South, Jammu vide order No: 73 of 2026 Dated: 11/07/2026 & S.No. 3, 4 Accorded by District Development Commissioner, Jammu vide order No: 311-DDCJ of 2026 Dated: 10/07/2026.

Position of TS :- S.No. 1, 2 Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD(R&B) Circle South, Jammu vide order No: 66 of July 2026 & S.No. 3, 4 Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD(R&B) Circle South, Jammu vide order No: 63 of July 2026.

Project Authority :- S.No. 1, 2(Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Zone Jammu) & S.No. 3, 4(District Development Commissioner, Jammu) Major Head of Account - S.No. 1, 2(Under Non Plan for the year 2026-27) & S.No. 3, 4(Under SSV/PWD(R&B) Component)

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	28-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 28-07-2026 to 05-08-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	31-07-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura
4	Bid Submission Start Date	28-07-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	05-08-2026 upto 1600 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	06-08-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. In case mentioned bid opening date happens to be a holiday then Bid shall be opened at the same time on the next working day.
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of **Treasury Receipt/e-challan in favour of Executive Engineer PWD(R&B) Division R S Pura through Treasury, indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and Date and name of work duly creditable to 0059 (Revenue) and Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura.** The CDR/FDR/BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 be submitted to the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura at the time of allotment.

2. The date of Treasury Challan, Earnest Money/Bid Security must be between the date of start of bid and Bid Submission End Date. However, if the tender for the same work has been re-invited after 1st or More calls, the bidders who have already bid for that work can re-use the same Treasury Challan/Earnest Money/Bid Security in the successive calls for the said work provided there should not be any overwriting or forging on the previously uploaded documents.

3. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidders needs not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender documents. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential-submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.

4. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site www.jktenders.gov.in and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The **Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura.** The date for same shall be intimated separately.

5. The bids for the work shall remain **valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical bids.**

6. **The earnest money shall be forfeited, if :-**

- Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
- Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issuance of letter of acceptance.
- Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ/G/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.

7. Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process.

1. Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the "Downloads" option as well as from "Bidders Manual Kit" on website www.jktenders.gov.in to acquaint bid submission process.
2. To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get "Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)" as per Information Technology Act-2000. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors.
3. The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic format with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.
4. Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.
5. Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid documents.

Note:- Scan all the documents on 100 dpi with black and white option.

8. The department will not be responsible for any delay in online submission due to any reasons.

9. Correctness of Information on the notarized affidavit which must be notarized between the period of downloading of bidding document as per the format mentioned in the e-NIT/SBD with the technical documents of the bid must be uploaded with the bids in the form of scanned copy and also be produced in original at the time of allotment.

10. Bidders may contact office of the Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department, Jammu or concerned Executive Engineer for any guidance for getting DSC or any other relevant details in respect of e-tendering process.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division
R.S. Pura

DIP/J- 6957/26, Jul 30 2026

TO ADVERTISE PLEASE CONTACT

Mr. N SELVA KUMAR

PH: 9820350726

selvakumar.n@thehindu.co.in

THE HINDU

India's National Newspaper

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Single Tender Notice No.:
SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T12
Date 29-07-2026

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRD, North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India invites sealed "SINGLE" E-Tender for the following work:-

Sl. No-01, Name of work: Annual Maintenance Contract of SCADA system of RCC in CHPG-GKC Section of Varanasi Division N.E. Railway for Two years. Tender reference no.: SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T12, Approx. Cost (in Rs.): ₹ 38,86,103.04, Earnest Money (in Rs.): ₹ 77,700/-, Cost of tender documents(in Rs.): Nil, E-Tender closing date and time: 20-08-2026 up to 15:30 Hrs., Completion period: 24 Months.

- Single E-Tender Online will be submitted up to 15:30 Hrs. on date 20-08-2026.
- For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian Railway i.e. www.cirps.gov.in

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD
CPRO/Vidut-119 Varanasi

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE
NIT No.TKD-15-2026, Date: 27.07.2026

Sr. Divisional Electric Engineer/TRS/ Electric Loco Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-44, acting for and on behalf of The President of India, invites E-Tenders against the following Tenders, with the closing date 18.08.2026. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders, and any manual offer received shall be ignored.

TENDER/BID NO.: TKD-15-2026.
NAME OF WORK AND STATION : "Dismantling, Removing, Painting & Cleaning of Bogie & its Parts, Helical Springs, Gear Case of Electric Loco for a period of 03 years". **QTY. :** As per Schedule of Rates, **ESTIMATED COST (INRS.) :** 43,38,924.90, **COST OF TENDER FORM (IN RS.) :** NIL, **EARNEST MONEY (IN RS.) :** 86800/-, **COMPLETION PERIOD :** 36 Months, **LAST DT. & TIME OF SUBMISSION OF TENDER :** 18.08.2026 at 15:30 Hrs **Note:-1.** E-Tender document and details of E-tender will be available on website www.irops.gov.in Portal. **2.** Manual offer will not be acceptable for this E-Tender; in case manual offer received then offer will not be considered. **3.** For any correction in this tender, corrigendum will be up-loaded on website, which may be seen up-to the date of tender opening. **4.** Tenderer must have class-III, digital signature certificate and will have to register on IREPS portal. **(Sd)**
For Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRS)
Electric Loco Shed, Tughlakabad
West Central Railway, New Delhi

सचिव भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

GOVERNMENT OF ARUNACHAL PRADESH
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER:
JAIRAMPUR DIVISION, PWD, AP

No. JD/DB/NIT/E-tender/2026-27/796-803 Dated 30/07/2026

Notice Inviting e-Tender

The Executive Engineer, Jairampur Division, PWD, Jairampur, invites on behalf of the Governor of Arunachal Pradesh, invites e-tender for the work **"Construction of Road from MV road near Assam Rifles Camp to Miao Singpho Village in Changlang District under CRIP"**.

The bid forms and other details can be obtained from the web portal <https://arunachaltenders.gov.in> 10:00 hrs of 31/07/2026 onwards.

Executive Engineer
Jairampur Division, PWD, AP
Jairampur

DIPR/ARN-209

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Victoria Cross Vihar, Ghat Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001
Corporate Identity No. UA40109UP2001SGC025867/2358
Telephone-(0135)-2763672-76, Website: www.uktdenders.gov.in

CORRIGENDUM TO E-TENDER NOTICE

This office e-tender specification no. CCP-II/7/2026-2027 invited previously for supply of 500 Nos. LT Puffer Resistant Metering Cubicle is hereby extended due to unavoidable reasons. The e-tender can be purchased and submitted upto 17:00 hrs of **13.08.2026**. Part-1 of the e-tender shall be opened on **14.08.2026** at 15:30 hrs.

Other terms and conditions will remain same as per original tender notice. For further details, please visit our website www.uktdenders.gov.in.

No: 579/EE(CM)/UPCLA-2 **Superintending Engineer**
Corporate (Contract & Procurement-II)

SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION. Use LED Bulbs to Save Electricity
(Toll Free No. 1912) "Pay Electricity Bill Online 24x7 from www.upel.org (For Information on Electricity theft, Informer may report to Toll free No. 18001804185/ Fax No. 0135-2760911)

MANEKSHAW CENTRE
PARADE ROAD, DELHI CANTT-10
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

1. ADG, Adm & Coord invites sealed tender from vendors for hiring agency for 96 civil allied manpower at Manekshaw Centre, Delhi Cantt-10 for a period of three years extendable as per the terms and conditions.

2. The tender documents (RFP) may be collected from Main Office, Manekshaw Centre, Delhi Cantt-10, between 1000hrs to 1700 hrs wef 05 August 2026 to 17 August 2026 on any working day against submission of tender documents fee of Rs 2500/- (Rupees Two Thousand and Five Hundred only) in the form of Demand Draft/Bankers cheque in favour of **'Manekshaw Centre Main Act'** or Cash.

3. Sealed tender documents as per RFP will be dropped in the tender box placed at the Main Office of Manekshaw Centre by 1700hrs on 30 August 2026.

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878

Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU **thehindubusinessline.**

FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR THE HINDU YOUNG WORLD THE HINDU

ARMY WELFARE EDUCATION SOCIETY
(Registered under Societies Registration Act XXI of 1860)

REQUIREMENT OF AGENCY FOR CONDUCT OF ONLINE SCREENING TEST

1. Army Welfare Education Society (AWES) invites tenders from registered, eligible agencies for conduct of **'ONLINE SCREENING TEST'** for selection of teachers for Army Public Schools under Army Welfare Education Society.

2. **"REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)"** for tender is available on the [website www.awesindia.com](http://www.awesindia.com).

समुद्री उत्पाद निर्यात विकास प्राधिकरण
THE MARINE PRODUCTS EXPORT DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
(वाणिज्य एवं उद्योग मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
(Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Govt. of India)
एमपीडीईए हाउस, पनम्पिल्ली एवेन्यू / MPEDA House, Panampilly Avenue
कोच्चि, केरल / Kochi, Kerala - 682 036.
(दूरभाष / Tel: 0484-2311901) ईमेल / Email: ho@mpeda.gov.in
वेबसाइट / Website: www.mpeda.gov.in

युवा पेशेवर (आईटी) । व । II / YOUNG PROFESSIONAL (IT) - I & II

समुद्री उत्पाद निर्यात विकास प्राधिकरण (एमपीडीईए), कोच्ची स्थित अपने मुख्यालय में संविदा आधार पर युवा पेशेवर (आईटी) - I व II के पद के लिए ऑनलाइन आवेदन आमंत्रित करती है।

- संविदा की शुरुआती अवधि: 1 साल
- अवधि बढ़ाना: आवश्यकता / कार्यनिष्पादन के आधार पर इसे 3 साल तक बढ़ाया जा सकता है। विस्तृत अधिसूचना और ऑनलाइन आवेदन के लिए: एमपीडीईए की आधिकारिक वेबसाइट, अधिसूचना — अवसर — ओपनिंग लिस्ट

ऑनलाइन आवेदन प्राप्त होने की अंतिम तिथि: 25.08.2026

The Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) invite online applications for the posts of Young Professional (IT) - I & II for engagement at its Head Office in Kochi on a contractual basis.

- Initial contract period: 1 year
- Extension: Extendable up to 3 years based on requirements/performance

For detailed notification and online application, visit:
MPEDA Official Website, Notification —> Opportunities —> Opening List
Last date of receipt of online application: 25.08.2026

हस्ता / Sd/-
सचिव/ SECRETARY

झारखण्ड सरकार

स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग

प्रेस विज्ञापित

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु विज्ञापन।

स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड के नियंत्रणाधीन शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, धनबाद, एम0जी0एम0 चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, जमशेदपुर, कुल0 ज्ञानो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, दुमका, मेदिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, पलामू तथा शेख भिखारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, हजारीबाग के विभिन्न विभागों में विभागवार प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

विभागवार प्राध्यापक पद की रिक्ति की विवरणी निम्नांकित है जो अधिक / कम हो सकती है:-

क्र0 सं0	विभाग का नाम	कुल रिक्ति	UR	ST	SC
1	एनाटोमी	5	3	1	1
2	फिजियोलॉजी	3	2	0	1
3	बायोकेमिस्ट्री	2	1	1	0
4	पैथोलॉजी	4	2	1	1
5	माईक्रोबायोलॉजी	3	2	1	0
6	एफ0एम0टी0	4	3	1	0
7	फार्माकोलॉजी	2	1	1	0
8	पी0एस0एम0	2	1	1	0
9	औषधि	3	2	0	1
10	शिशु रोग	5	4	1	0
11	सर्जरी	3	2	0	0
12	अस्थि	3	3	0	1
13	ई0एम0टी0	5	4	1	0
14	नेत्र	4	3	1	0
15	स्त्री एवं प्रसव	1	1	0	0
16	निश्चेतना	2	1	0	1
17	रक्त अधीकोष	3	2	1	0
18	दन्त	2	1	1	0
Total		56	38	12	6

2. अर्हता — प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु एम0सी0आई / एन0एम0सी0 के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव लागू होगा।

3. चयन का आधार — Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु गठित चयन समिति द्वारा विहित प्रक्रिया के अन्तर्गत तत्संबंधी अभिलेखों की जाँच की जायेगी। तदनुसार विभागवार रिक्ति के विरुद्ध चयनित अभ्यर्थियों के नाम की अनुशंसा की जायेगी।

4. नियुक्ति की शर्तें —

- प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने के लिए एम0सी0आई / एन0एम0सी0 के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव संबंधी प्रावधान लागू होंगे।
- चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर पदधारकों को समय-समय पर वित्त विभाग द्वारा दिये गये परामर्श के अनुरूप मासिक मानदेय देय होगा। इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता / सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।
- चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा आधारित सेवाएँ अधिकतम 02 वर्ष अथवा नियमित नियुक्ति / प्रनॉलित, जो पहले हो, तक अथवा 70 वर्ष की आयु तक होगी।
- 02 वर्ष की संविदा अवधि की समाप्ति के उपरान्त उनके Performance का मूल्यांकन संतोषजनक पाये जाने पर आगामी वर्षों हेतु एक बार में एक वर्ष के लिए सेवा विस्तार वित्त विभाग की सहमति से किया जायेगा।
- संविदा आधारित यह नियुक्ति पूर्णतः औपबंधिक होगी एवं संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु चयनित अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा भविष्य में नियमित नियुक्ति एवं अन्य सुविधाओं का दावा नहीं किया जायेगा।
- अवकाश — संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षाओं के लिए अधिकतम उम्र सीमा सभी वर्गों के लिए 70 वर्ष होगी।
- किसी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय में संविदा पर नियुक्त प्राध्यापक का स्थानांतरण किसी अन्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल में नहीं किया जायेगा।
- सभी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों में प्राध्यापक के उतने ही पद इस व्यवस्था से भरे जायेंगे जितना नितान्त आवश्यक होगा। इन पदों पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आखण्ड प्रतिशत का अनुपालन किया जायेगा।
- वित्त विभाग से प्राप्त परामर्श के आधार पर मंत्रिपरिषद् द्वारा लिए गए निर्णय के अनुसार संविदा राशि निर्धारण के संबंध में विभागीय संकल्प-407 (9) दिनांक 02.09.2021 एवं विभागीय अधिसूचना 357 (9) दिनांक 30.07.2024 के आलोक में प्राध्यापक के पद पर नियुक्त पद धारक को मानदेय— प्राध्यापक 2,50,000 /— (दो लाख पचास हजार रुपये) देय होगा इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता या सुविधा देय नहीं होगा।

5. अधिकतम उम्र सीमा — संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षाओं के लिए अधिकतम उम्र सीमा सभी वर्गों के लिए 70 वर्ष होगी।

6. रिक्त पदों पर वाक—इन—इन्टरव्यू लिस्ट, रैंकी के प्रशासनिक भवन में निम्नांकित तिथियों में सम्पन्न होगा —

क्र0 सं0	पदनाम	दिनांक	समय
01	प्राध्यापक	03.08.2026	पूर्वाह्न 10:30 बजे से

7. सभी इच्छुक उम्मीदवार वेबसाइट — www.jharkhand.gov.in/health के अन्तर्गत Recruitment पर दिये गये आवेदन पत्र में अंकित सभी वांछित सूचनाएँ पूर्णरूपेण भर कर, सभी मूल प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वयं प्रामाणित छायाप्रति एवं मूल प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ वाक—इन—इन्टरव्यू आयोजन की तिथि पर ससमय भाग लेंगे।

8. इस विज्ञापन को स्थगित करने, किसी आवेदन को बिना कोई कारण बताए स्वीकृत / अस्वीकृत करने एवं रिक्ति के अवशेष रहने की अवस्था में पुनः विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करने का सर्वाधिकार स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग को सुरक्षित रहेगा।

निदेशक,
चिकित्सा शिक्षा,
झारखंड, राँची

PR: 386389 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare (26-27)_D

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

Telephone No.:-0177-2621398
E-mail ID:- ee-leel1-hp@nic.in

The **Executive Engineer Electrical Division No-I, HPPWD, Kasumpti, Shimla-9** on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the online bids on **percentage rate**, in electronic tendering system in **Two cover system** from the eligible and approved contractors / firms registered with HPPWD (Electrical) department in appropriate class for the works as mentioned below:-

S. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost	Earnest Money	Time	Eligible class of registration
1.	AMC of 62.50KVA DG Set installed at Hon'ble Governor Guest House and 100KVA D.G set installed at Hon'ble Governor's Residence Lok Bhawan Shimla-2 w.e.f 20.01.2026 to 19.01.2027.	Rs. 1,19,121/-	12000/-	One month	specialized
2.	C/O Forest Rest House building at Kandhar Tehsil Arki, Distt. Solan (H.P) (SH- Providing E.I therein).	Rs. 13,16,485/-	26500/-	Six Months	"B"
3.	Replacement of damaged/ unserviceable part of 10KVA UPS installed at Block-D of Nirman Bhawan building Nigam Vihar Shimla-2.	Rs. 1,18,552/-	2400/-	Three Months	specialized
4.	R/O Fire Fighting & Fire Alarm system of Ellerslie, Armsade and Yojna Bhawan building at H.P Secretariat Chotta Shimla H.P for the year 2026-27 w.e.f 19-08-2026 to 18-08-2027.	Rs. 12,92,850/-	26000/-	One year	specialized
5.	Providing one number Driver for Swift Desire HP 52 B 0428 allotted to Superintending Engineer 1" Electrical Circle HPPWD Shimla-9 From 01/08/2026 to 31/07/2027.	Rs. 29,731/-	4600/-	One year	"C"
6.	Providing one no. Driver for Bolero Camper car Vehicle NO. HP 18A Nahan/ Solan 8228 under Assistant Engineer HPPWD Elect. Sub Div. (SH- Providing Services of Driver for the year 2026-27).	Rs. 2,23,380/-	4500/-	One year	"C"
7.	Repair of Seismic Vulnerability and Retrofit of Health and Lift Line Building of Govt. Community Health Center at Paonta Sahib (H.P) under Depot Head (SH- Providing Rewiring to E.I in CHC building (Labour & Children ward Area) at Paonta Sahib).	Rs. 7,80,577/-	15800/-	One year	"C"
8.	Providing rewiring in type IV set No. 4 Below Pine Chotta Shimla-2.	Rs. 2,19,715/-	4400/-	Three Months	"C"
9.	Providing Staff for running of Electrical enquiry in Armsade Phase-II building at H.P secretariat/ Chotta Shimla-2 w.e. f 05/08/2026 to 04/08/2027.	Rs. 4,64,185/-	10000/-	One year	"C"
10.	Replacement of defective materials of One No. Lifts TK Make 26 Passenger at 100 bedded Hospital at Dhami, District Shimla.	Rs. 5,66,109/-	11500/-	One year	"specialized"
Starting date of downloading bid		31.07.2026			
Deadline for submission of bid					



DOUBLE DELIGHT

Judokas
Harsh, Asmita
strike gold

SPORT » PAGE 15



STUDENTS' STIR

Want to forgive those
who abused me: Modi

NEWS » PAGE 8

UNSAFE HOME

*Celebrated at
birth, pushed
into sex work*

Banchhadas of M.P. are
caught in a vicious cycle

GROUND ZERO » PAGE 7



IB OFFICER MURDER CASE

Ex-AAP councillor
receives life sentence

CITY » PAGE 2

IN BRIEF



'No firing' claim:
Congress moves
privilege motion

NEW DELHI
Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal on Friday submitted a notice to move a privilege motion against Union Minister Jitendra Singh for telling the Lok Sabha that "no firing took place" during the student protests in Delhi. » **Page 9**

Assam flood toll
reaches 80, over
2 lakh people hit

GUWAHATI
The death toll due to floods in Assam increased to 80 with two more fatalities while eight districts and 2.12 lakh people remain affected, officials said on Friday. The officials said the two deaths were reported from Sivasagar district. » **Page 3**

Karnataka outfits call
for bandh on Aug. 13
over Cauvery water

B.S. Sathish Kumar
BENGALURU

Various organisations in Karnataka have called a State bandh on August 13 in protest against the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA)'s directive to release water to Tamil Nadu.

On Thursday, the CWMA upheld the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee's (CWRC) earlier order to Karnataka to release 3,500 cusecs of Cauvery water to Tamil Nadu for 15 days. Citing poor storage in its reservoirs, Karnataka has been reiterating its inability to release water to Tamil Nadu.

A decision to call the bandh was taken at a meeting of various Kannada organisations held in Bengaluru on Friday under the leadership of veteran leader and former MLA Vatal Nagaraj.

Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar appealed to the organisations not to go



A protest in Bengaluru on Friday. SUDHAKARA JAIN

ahead with the bandh. He said the government would decide its next move only after getting advice from legal experts and after consulting the Opposition parties at an all-party meeting on Sunday.

In view of the tense atmosphere in the State, Mr. Shivakumar appealed to his Tamil Nadu counterpart, C. Joseph Vijay, to put off his visit to Karnataka.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 8**

Trump touts Gaza deal,
 Hamas seeks Israeli exit

U.S. leader hails 'historic agreement' on disarmament; Palestinian militant group acknowledges deal, says it will abandon weapons only if Israel withdraws troops and 'stops killing Palestinians'

Stanly Johny

U.S. President Donald Trump on Friday announced that the Board of Peace, an organisation Washington established to oversee a Gaza ceasefire, has reached a "historic agreement" for the disarmament of Hamas and other militant organisations in the Palestinian enclave.

"Today, the Board of Peace reached a historic agreement for the complete disarmament of Hamas and all other armed groups in Gaza. This is a monumental step toward lasting peace and security," Mr. Trump wrote in a social media post.

Hamas, the Palestinian militant group that runs parts of Gaza, made an official statement acknowledging the deal, but added that it would abandon weapons



Displaced Palestinians walk past destroyed buildings and makeshift shelters near the al-Shati refugee camp, west of Gaza City. AFP

and end its rule only if Israel, which currently occupies more than 60% of the enclave, withdraws its troops and "stops killing Palestinians".

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu did not immediately respond to Mr. Trump's announcement, but National Security Minister Itamar Ben Gvir said the deal was "unac-

ceptable". He said the "assassinations in Gaza must continue". Israeli media quoted "a senior official" as saying in a statement that "there will be no IDF withdrawal from Gaza without the genuine disarmament of Hamas".

According to Mr. Trump, the agreement is a step towards Gaza finally being governed by a new

Palestinian government in coordination with the Board of Peace. "At the same time, Israel will have the security it deserves, with Gaza no longer used as a base for terror attacks," he wrote.

"This is a major milestone in the implementation of the Trump 20-Point Plan. The agreement will be carried out in carefully structured phases," Mr. Trump said on Friday. "As disarmament is completed, Israeli forces will withdraw, and the International Stabilization Force will work with a new Palestinian police force to take responsibility for Gaza being safe for its residents and its neighbours."

The U.S. leader thanked Egypt, Qatar, and Turkiye for their mediation efforts.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 8**

One person
killed, another
injured in J&K
terror attack

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Suspected terrorists shot dead a migrant worker and injured another in a targeted attack in south Kashmir's Kulgam on Friday evening. It is the second targeted attack in the region since July 22.

A senior police officer told *The Hindu* that two workers were fired upon in Kilam. "One died and another was being operated," said the officer.

Officials said the injured person was taken to the Government Medical College, Anantnag, "for advanced treatment".

Preliminary reports suggested that suspected terrorists fired at the two workers after sundown and fled the spot. Security forces have cordoned off the attack site and a search operation was on to trace the attackers.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 8**

Human tide



Seeking sanctuary: Migrants trying to cross from Morocco into Ceuta, a Spanish enclave in north Africa. About 60,000 migrants have crossed into the territory in 24 hours, according to Ceuta's President on Friday. AP (REPORT: PAGE 12)

Lok Sabha passes Births and Deaths Bill
amid protests over police crackdown

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Lok Sabha on Friday passed the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 without debate amid loud protests by the Opposition against the police crackdown on student protesters at Jantar Mantar on July 20.

The Opposition protests began as soon as the House convened at 11 a.m., forcing Speaker Om Birla to adjourn it till noon. The ruckus continued when the House reassembled.

BJP MP Dilip Saikia, who was in the chair, asked for listed papers to be laid on the table. These included grant of deadline extension to the Joint Parliamentary



Proceedings under way in the Lok Sabha on Friday. ANI

Committee examining the Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, 2025 for submission of report. The Constitution Amendment Bill proposes the automatic removal of Ministers, Chief Minister, or Prime Minister if they are arrested and held in custody for 30 days on serious criminal charges

carrying a jail term of five years or more.

Following this, Minister of State for Home Nityanand Rai put up the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill for discussion. It seeks to make delayed registration of births and deaths more stringent by requiring an

order from a judicial magistrate (first class) for registrations done after two years.

Unfortunate, says Rijiju
The Opposition MPs then trooped into the Well of the House demanding the presence of Home Minister Amit Shah even as Mr. Saikia called out the names of MPs listed to speak during the debate. The Bill was passed by voice vote amid sloganeering.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said the passage of the Bill in this manner was unfortunate. "Please do not repeat this in the future. People who sent you to Parliament will seek answers from you," he said.

Stone-laden
truck: Cong.
flags differing
police claims

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Friday flagged conflicting claims made by the Delhi police and their counsel in the Delhi High Court regarding the presence of a truck loaded with stones and bricks near Jantar Mantar, the protest site from where the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) called for a march to Parliament on July 20 over the NEET paper leak row, as a "major contradiction".

Indian Youth Congress (IYC) national president Uday Bhanu Chib said initially the truck was near Jantar Mantar on July 20, but by afternoon was parked outside the IYC office on Raisina Marg. "The government counsel stated [on July 22] in the High Court that the truck was linked to the protesters. On July 28, Delhi Police tweeted that the truck had been seized following an accident. This in itself is a major contradiction," he said.

The Deputy Commissioner of Police, New Delhi, said claims alleging that the truck was deliberately deployed by the police were false and misleading.



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke had flagged the stone-laden truck's presence near Jantar Mantar on July 20. @ABHIJEET_DIPKE

Four-storey building collapse
leaves 10 dead in Maharashtra



Rescue bid: NDRF and civil defence personnel carrying out search operations in the Balaji Nagar area of Bhiwandi in Maharashtra's Thane district. EMMANUAL YOGINI

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

At least 10 people were killed and three injured after a four-storey residential building, declared "dangerous" by the civic body in September 2020 and undergoing illegal repairs, collapsed in Bhiwandi city in Maharashtra late on Thursday night.

Residents of the 48-room Kohinoor Building, located 50 km from Mumbai, said they heard "loud cracking sounds" around 9 p.m. Local people began evacuating the families and around 30 to 35 people escaped through the back gate.

Rescue teams from the National Disaster Response Force, Thane Disaster Response Force, and the fire brigade launched rescue operations, deploying heavy machinery and sniffer dogs to locate survivors.

A three-year-old girl was among the 10 rescued from the rubble of the structure built in 2010.

An NDRF official said 10 bodies were recovered

from the site and appealed to the public to inform authorities about any missing persons. "If no one comes forward, we will stop rescue operation after the commissioner's order," the official said.

Five of the deceased have been identified as Shamim Shaikh, 32, Ranjeet Singh, 45, Miraj Rasul Shaikh, 34, Santosh Kumar Pandey, 42, and Shamim Ansari, 30.

Repeated notices

The Bhiwandi Nizampur City Municipal Corporation said that after repeated notices, eviction orders were issued to the residents on June 5, and electricity and water connections were snapped. The owners of the building began structural repair work without obtaining permission from the civic body. On Thursday, hours before the collapse, an inspection team led by an assistant municipal commissioner found the structure unstable and evacuated around 40 residents and labourers.

Officials said the contractor and the workers were instructed to stop the repair work but they ignored the orders. Some residents also refused to vacate the building. A witness said the contractor had removed two pillars during repair work.

The civic body's commissioner ordered criminal proceedings and action against the contractor.

Maharashtra Water Resources and Disaster Management Minister Girish Mahajan visited the site and announced financial assistance of ₹5 lakh for families of each victim.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis expressed grief over the incident and directed officials to register a case and take action against those responsible.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced an *ex gratia* of ₹2 lakh for families of the deceased and ₹50,000 for the injured. "Pained to hear about the loss of lives due to the collapse of a building in Thane, Maharashtra," he said in a post on X.

INBRIEF



Govt. extends deadline for mandatory use of Saheli cards

The Delhi government on Friday extended the deadline for mandatory use of the Pink National Common Mobility Card, also called the Saheli card, for women commuters to avail free travel on Transport Department buses, with pink tickets continuing to be valid until August 15. Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said, “The mandatory use of the Saheli cards will now come into effect from August 16. The decision has been taken to facilitate a smooth transition and ensure no eligible commuter is inconvenienced.”

Shraddha Walkar murder: HC refuses to fix time limit for trial

The Delhi High Court on Friday refused to set a timeline for the conclusion of the trial in the Shraddha Walkar murder case, observing that the proceedings against accused Aaftab Amin Poonawala were already being conducted on a day-to-day basis. A single judge Bench of Justice Madhu Jain was hearing a petition filed by Shraddha's brother Shreejay Vijay Walkar, who contended the trial had been pending for a long period without a justifiable reason.

Correction window for DU one-year PG open till today

Delhi University has announced a correction window for candidates who have already registered for admission to its one-year postgraduate programmes for the 2026-27 academic session. The window will remain open till 11.59 p.m. on Saturday, according to a university notice. During this period, candidates will be allowed to edit their personal profiles or academic details. The deadline for completing Phases I and 2 registration ended at 11.59 p.m. on Friday.

Tahir Hussain, 4 others get life term for murder of IB officer during 2020 riots

Court denies police plea seeking death for ex-AAP councillor saying prosecution failed to establish that convicts are beyond reformation; all five awarded separate terms for offences such as rioting

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

A Delhi court on Friday sentenced former Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) councillor Tahir Hussain and four others to life imprisonment for the murder of Intelligence Bureau staffer Ankit Sharma during the 2020 north-east Delhi riots, describing the killing as one of “utmost brutality”. The court also observed that the victim was targeted “solely on account of his religion”.

“The crime was committed during the communal violence that erupted in the wake of the protests against CAA/NRC. The manner in which it was committed was of the utmost brutality. The victim was sucked in by the murderous mob, baying for blood, solely on account of his religion,” Additional Sessions Judge Parveen Singh of the Karkardooma Courts noted.

‘Rarest of rare’ category Even as the court noted that the murder reflected “barbarity of immense magnitude” and hence satisfied the “crime test” for the “rarest of rare” category, it declined capital punishment to the accused after finding that the



While sentencing Tahir Hussain on Friday, the court said IB officer Ankit Sharma was targeted 'solely on account of his religion'. ANI

prosecution had failed to establish that the convicts were beyond the possibility of reformation. The court also held that although the prosecution had established the convicts' guilt with the aid of Section 149 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC), no specific fatal act had been attributed to any individual accused during the murder. The absence of an individually proved role, the court said, constituted a “huge mitigation” while considering whether the death penalty should be imposed. The judge also rejected the prosecution's attempt to rely at the sentencing stage on allega-

tions that Hussain had instigated or led the mob, observing that those allegations had not been proved during the trial. The former AAP councillor has already been acquitted of conspiracy and abetment charges. In another notable observation, the court treated the poor educational background of four of the five convicts as a mitigating circumstance in the specific context of the riots. At the same time, it emphasised that they must face “the full force of the law”. All five convicts – Hussain, Nazim, Kasim, Javed and Anas – were sentenced to life imprison-

ment for murder under Section 302 read with Section 149 of the IPC. They were also awarded separate prison terms for rioting, promoting enmity, unlawful assembly and abduction, with all sentences directed to run concurrently. The court also ordered payment of compensation to the victim's family from the fines imposed on the convicts.

Reported missing The case relates to the FIR registered at the Dayalpur police station on the complaint of Sharma's father, who reported him missing after he failed to return home from a trip to buy groceries during the riots. Sharma's body was later recovered from a drain near Chand Bagh Pulia. In his complaint, he named Hussain and others. During the trial, which lasted over six years, the prosecution examined 91 witnesses and relied on eyewitness accounts, forensic evidence and call detail records to establish its case. In March 2023, the trial court framed charges against 11 accused, including Hussain, for rioting, murder, abduction, criminal conspiracy and promoting enmity. Of these, Hussain, Nazim, Kasim, Javed and Anas were convicted on July 14.

Triumph of justice vs Hussain a BJP man: parties trade barbs

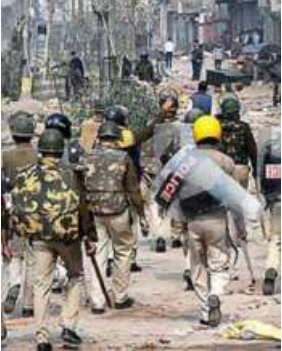
The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A war of words broke out between the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and the Opposition Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Friday following the sentencing of former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain and four others to life imprisonment for the murder of Intelligence Bureau officer Ankit Sharma during the 2020 north-east Delhi riots.

While the BJP hailed the court order for “establishing how AAP-backed miscreants spread riots”, the Opposition party hit back, claiming that Hussain had been “indirectly working for the BJP”.

Welcoming the order, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said people of Delhi are now demanding answers from AAP. “Hussain was arrested on charges of murder, yet even after that, [AAP chief Arvind] Kejriwal and [AAP leader] Manish Sisodia stood in his support! They kept trying relentlessly to save him! Why? Will Mr. Kejriwal tell the people of Delhi? Was it under their patronage that people like Hussain conspired to incite riots? Today, justice has triumphed. This verdict further strengthens the faith of every citizen of the country in the law and the judiciary,” she posted on X.

Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra said, “Kejriwal should be ashamed for not only sheltering such criminals within the party but also for repeated-



Fifty-three people died and more than 700 were injured in the Feb. 2020 riots. FILE PHOTO

ly using his influence to protect them. The true character of the Aam Aadmi Party is now well understood not only by the people of Delhi but also by the people of Punjab.” Delhi Law Minister Kapil Mishra said the sentencing was “the beginning of justice”.

‘BJP strategy’ Addressing a press conference, AAP's State unit chief Saurabh Bharadwaj said his party had expelled Hussain as soon as an FIR was registered against him in the Ankit Sharma murder case. Mr. Bharadwaj said Hussain had contested the Mustafabad Assembly election last year on an All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen ticket as part of a “well-planned strategy by the BJP”. “There are dozens of instances where the BJP has embraced individuals involved in the most heinous crimes. In reality, Hussain was a BJP man. If anyone gained political advantage from the Delhi riots, it was the BJP,” he added.

Barapullah corridor all set to open

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

In a major relief to commuters between east and south Delhi, Phase 3 of the signal-free Barapullah elevated corridor is complete after a delay of over a decade, and is expected to open for traffic this month, officials said on Friday.



L-G T.S. Sandhu at the Kamla Nehru Ridge. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

L-G leads plantation drive in Ridge; seeks survival monitoring

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday led a plantation drive organised by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA), during which more than one lakh native trees and shrubs were planted across 77 locations in the national capital.

The L-G, who is also the DDA Chairperson, directed the urban body to make such drives a regular exercise and appoint a nodal officer for each site to ensure the survival of saplings. At Kamla Nehru Ridge, Mr. Sandhu said plantation efforts should evolve into a people's movement with greater youth participation.

“Such initiatives should be driven by the youth and

aimed at them,” he said, adding that the present generation has a responsibility to leave behind an ecologically richer Delhi. He also called for similar drives across other Ridge areas and urged the DDA to take a more proactive role in expanding the city's green cover. Close to 200 people, including students, participated in the drive at Kamla Nehru Ridge. Similar drives were also held at Aravalli Biodiversity Park and Sanjay Van, featuring native species such as dhok, amaltas, peepal and neem. The events were part of the urban body's afforestation programme and the 70 Lakh Plantation Mission, under which the DDA is tasked with planting 23 lakh saplings in Delhi.

CM Gupta distributes bicycles to over 3,000 Class 9 girls

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi government on Friday launched the Vidya Vahini Yojana, under which more than 3,000 Class 9 girl students in government schools received bicycles. The scheme aims to improve access to education by easing travel to schools, boosting attendance and minimising dro-

pouts. Speaking at the launch of the scheme at East Vinod Nagar, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said that 1.4 lakh girls would receive bicycles under the scheme in multiple phases. In a post on X, Ms. Gupta stated, “These bicycles will make it easier for daughters to go to school, increase attendance, provide more opportunities

for studies and sports, reduce family expenses and, above all, give a new flight to their confidence.” During the event, the CM interacted with students and spoke to them about their studies and future aspirations. Education Minister Ashish Sood said the scheme intends to help girls who struggle to continue their education due to the lack of transport.



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta posing with beneficiaries of the Vidya Vahini Yojana, in East Vinod Nagar on Friday. ANI

BLOs in race against time as only 57.54% SIR forms digitised so far

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

With a week remaining for the door-to-door enumeration phase of the special intensive revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls, only 57.54% of enumeration forms have been digitised, even though 99.91% have been distributed, according to data released by the office of Chief Electoral Officer Ashok Kumar on Friday. Booth-Level Officers (BLOs) said they were struggling to meet deadlines amid a mounting workload while a citizens' collective assisting voters alleged that many electors had not received forms despite official claims of near-complete distribution. The door-to-door verification phase, initially scheduled to end on July 29, was extended till August 8. The draft rolls will be published on August 17.

Inadequate clarity

A BLO posted in North Delhi said officials were under pressure to achieve “unrealistic” daily targets. “We are being told to get 60-70 forms completed every day. How can we ensure that every form is verified



Several people have approached our organisation saying they have never seen their BLO and have never received a form

MAANSI VERMA
Member, Voter Adhikar Manch

and correct in that time? Many people still do not have their forms filled. We have to help them complete those. Migrant families take much longer because addresses and records have to be verified. At the same time, we have to finish door-to-door visits,” he said. He added that the workload had begun affecting his health. “I have been taking medicines for stress for the past week on my doctor's advice. I was experiencing an increased heartbeat and pain in my arms.”

Another BLO said officials were grappling with anomalies in voter records without adequate clarity on how to resolve them. “If it is a simple name mismatch, we know how to deal with it. But there are

cases where a voter is linked to someone else in another State or where there are other errors. Those records cannot simply be undone, so we end up searching for another family member to verify details.”

Letter to EC Voter Adhikar Manch, a citizens' collective working on electoral rights in the Delhi-National Capital Region and assisting voters during the SIR process, has written to the Election Commission (EC) and the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer seeking clarity on issues being faced by electors. Maansi Verma, a member of the collective, said many voters claimed they had never received enumeration forms. “Several people have approached us saying they have never seen their BLO.”

In its letter, the collective stated that the process assumed every elector was digitally literate. “Enumeration forms are being signed or thumb-marked without being read to the elector, while errors in names, age and relationships are often discovered after submission,” it stated.

Delhi HC seeks police response to third bail plea by Umar Khalid

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Friday asked Delhi Police to respond to a plea by activist Umar Khalid seeking bail in a case related to the “larger conspiracy” behind the February 2020 north-east Delhi riots.

A Bench of Justice Prathiba M. Singh and Justice Vikas Mahajan asked Delhi Police to file its response within two weeks.

Mr. Khalid said it was his third bail application since his arrest in September 2020 and that he was seeking interim bail in the case based on similar relief given to the other co-accused by the Supreme Court.

The Bench said it will hear the plea on August 27 when the bail plea of co-accused Sharjeel Imam is also listed.

Mr. Khalid has challenged a trial court's July 4 decision dismissing his bail application.

The Bench will hear the petition on Aug. 27 when the bail plea of co-accused Sharjeel Imam is also listed

had also rejected Mr. Imam's bail plea, and both cases could be taken up together by the Bench.

September 2020 arrest Arrested in September 2020, Mr. Khalid has been booked under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) on allegations of being one of the “masterminds” behind the riots that left 53 people dead and over 700 injured.

Activists Sharjeel Imam and Khalid Saifi, among others, have also been booked for their alleged involvement in the ‘larger conspiracy’ case, which is being investigated by Delhi Police's Special Cell.

On July 4, the trial court rejected Mr. Khalid's bail application, stating that it had “no option but to follow” the Supreme Court's January 5 order rejecting his plea for relief.

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LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE HON. ADDITIONAL DISTRICT & SESSIONS JUDGE (MACI) AMALAPURAM - EAST GODAVARI DISTRICT

M.V.O.P.N.O. 73/2020

Between
Mediseti Lakshmi Bhavani @
Yelabhoyna Lakshmi Bhavani and
others
...Petitioner
and
Rakesh Kumar Gaur and others
...Respondents

Notice to Respondent:
R1. Rakesh Kumar Gaur, S/o Sriram Manohar Gaur, Age not known, Pandey Ka Purwa, Meera Bhawan, Pratapgarh, Uttar Pradesh, Lucknow and Delhi out station edition, Pin: 230 001 (Driver of 12 tyres Ashok Leyland Turbo Tractor cum Trailer (Chemical Container) lorry bearing Regd. No: MH 43 U 7163)

In the above M.V.O.P.N.O. 73/2020 the 1st respondent hearing date stand posted to 18.08.2026 at 10.30 AM before the 2nd additional district and sessions Judge Amalapuram, E. G. Dt., Hence take notice that if you fail to appear before the said court on that day, the matter will be decided ex parte in your absence.

Hearing date: 18.08.2026

Sd/- N. Rajasekhara, Advocate,
Amalapuram, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
Konaseema Dist., A.P.
Cell: 9849193665

TENDERS

TENDER NOTICE

SATHWIK RURAL AND YOUTH INTEGRATED ASSOCIATION

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• Ref. No: SRVIA/OT/2026/04

• Closing Date: 04-Aug-2026

Detailed tender documents and terms can be obtained from the contact below.

Contact: CH.Ramesh
Ph: 9000449222

With profound grief and deep sorrow, we inform the sad demise of our beloved father, **Shri YK Sharma** who passed away peacefully on 25 July 2026 at the age of 65 years. He lived a life of integrity, compassion and devotion to his family. His cherished memories and values will continue to inspire all who knew him.

- In Grief -

Shantanu (Son) Dr Priya (Daughter)
Deeply mourned by
Kusum Sharma (Wife)
Paridhi (Daughter-in-law)
Dr Arjun (Son -in-law) & Sharma family

PUCL demands action against SHO for 'illegal' detentions

The Hindu Bureau
PATNA

The Bihar unit of the People's Union for Civil Liberties (PUCL) on Friday sought action against the police for allegedly illegally detaining, handcuffing, and harassing its members. It claimed that the police, in particular Station House Officer (SHO) Akhilesh Kumar Mishra of the Gandhi Maidan police station, took action against its members who were raising their voice against denial of due process to detained students.

Timings

DELHI

SATURDAY, AUG. 01

RISE 05:43

SET 19:12

RISE 20:52

SET 07:59

SUNDAY, AUG. 02

RISE 05:43

SET 19:12

RISE 21:21

SET 08:56

MONDAY, AUG. 03

RISE 05:44

SET 19:11

RISE 21:51

SET 09:54

Delhi Weather

	max	min
Delhi City	36	28
Safdarjang	36	28
Palam	35	26

Delhi Palam Today

34°C The weather will be warm. Night also will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower with gusty winds to occur.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow

33°C The weather will be warm. Spell of moderate rain and thundershower with strong winds to occur.

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THE HINDU
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Assam flood: death toll reaches 80, over 2 lakh people hit in 8 districts

Latest fatalities reported from Sivasagar district; 21 revenue circles, 437 villages continue to be affected; 75,583 people in 112 relief camps in four districts; State govt. announces 6-month moratorium on repaying loans taken by flood-hit people

Press Trust of India
GUWAHATI

The death toll due to floods in Assam rose to 80 with two more fatalities while eight districts and 2.12 lakh people remain affected, officials said on Friday.

Officials said the latest deaths were reported from Sivasagar district.

The State government has announced a six-month moratorium on repaying all types of loans availed by the flood-affected people while also demanding a support package from the Centre for the relief and rehabilitation of people ravaged by the unprecedented deluge.

Twenty-one revenue circles and 437 villages in Golaghat, Sivasagar, Biswanath, Charaideo, Kamrup (Metropolitan), Jorhat,



A man walking through thick mud left behind after floodwaters receded at Kamalchapor village in Sivasagar district; (right) a woman wading through water inside her house in Jorhat on Friday. ANI

Dhemaji and Nagaon districts continue to be hit.

A total of 2,12,400 people have been affected, including 80,000 in Charaideo, 71,000 in Sivasagar, and 40,000 in Jorhat.

The flood situation has improved since Wednesday, when seven districts

and more than three lakh people were affected. The administration is operating 112 relief camps and relief distribution centres in four districts, taking care of 75,583 affected people.

Multiple agencies such as the Army, National Disaster Response Force,



State Disaster Response Force, Fire & Emergency Service, police and civil agencies are engaged in rescue and relief work.

Crop area of 17,198.09 hectares has been submerged across the State.

Embankments, roads, bridges and other infras-

tructure have also been damaged by floodwaters.

Meeting with bankers
Meanwhile, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said a special meeting of the State-Level Bankers' Committee (SLBC) decided on a relief scheme for customers who availed of loans in Sivasagar, Charaideo, Jorhat, and Golaghat.

It was attended by representatives from the Reserve Bank of India, National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development, State Bank of India, and other commercial banks.

"The SLBC decided that a six-month moratorium will be offered to all flood-hit people in these districts," Mr. Sarma said.

He added that the tenure of loans can be extended from one year up to seven years.

Tribal land stir in Kerala: court acquits all who faced trial

The Hindu Bureau
KOZHIKODE

Bringing an end to a protracted 23-year legal marathon, the Principal Sessions Court, Kalpetta, in Kerala's Wayanad on Friday acquitted all those who faced trial, including social activist M. Geethanandan, in the case related to the murder of police constable K.V. Vinod during the Muthanga tribal land agitation on February 19, 2003.

Judge E. Ayyoobkhan set all those facing trial free as the prosecution failed to prove beyond reasonable doubt that there had been a prior conspiracy to murder the police constable.

However, the court found Ashokan, the second accused, guilty of delivering the fatal blow to Vinod's head during a rescue operation. The murder charge against him had to be abated because the accused died during the trial.



K.V. Narayani, mother of slain policeman K.V. Vinod, looks at her son's photograph after the verdict. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

However, the court convicted Geethanandan and three others of attempting to murder senior police constable Abdul Salam, abducting forest range officer P.K. Sasidharan, and criminal conspiracy.

The judge sentenced all four to five years of rigorous imprisonment. Each convict was also ordered to pay a fine of ₹42,000.

Of the 57 accused, 15 had passed away during the trial proceedings. One accused, Radhakrishnan, remains absconding.

Case against Noida woman for 'abusing' PM moved to Delhi

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

A day after reports of an FIR registered in Noida against a woman named Ruchika Singh for "abusing" Prime Minister Narendra Modi came to light, a Delhi Police officer on Friday said the case has been transferred to the Parliament Street police station.

When reached for comment, Deputy Commissioner of Police (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma said the

case had not yet been handed over to them as of Friday evening. "We will decide the course of action once we get it," he said.

On Wednesday, the U.P. police had registered a zero FIR at the Expressway police station based on a complaint by a Ghaziabad resident, Smriti Singh. The complainant alleged that Ms. Ruchika used "abusive and objectionable" language against Mr. Modi, thereby undermining "the dignity of the constitution-

al office". She claimed that the remarks were intended to "spread hatred and disrupt public peace".

'Misuse of machinery'
Reacting to the development, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) spokesperson Saurav Das said on X: "The misuse of criminal machinery against Ruchika Singh is unacceptable. Profanity does not attract a criminal case. The police can focus their energy elsewhere, not on a 25-year-old."

In a video statement, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke said, "Law should be the same for everyone. It cannot be used against the youth of the country and not against political leaders for using abusive language."

The FIR comes against the backdrop of the CJP-led protest at Jantar Mantar, which was called off on July 25 after Dharmendra Pradhan stepped down as the Union Education Minister. Since then, media clips and social media con-

tent posted by women protesters have been circulated on social media and they have been subjected to online harassment.

One such post on Friday by an X user identifying himself as Shashi Kumar, a co-convenor of the Bharatiya Janata Party's Uttar Pradesh social media unit, contained a video of three women and sought an FIR against them purportedly for similar "offences" as those Ms. Ruchika Singh is accused of.

अधिसूचना - जाहिर प्रगटण

कॉलेज ऑफ फिजिशियन्स अँड सर्जन्स ऑफ मुंबई

All the Fellows, who have completed 10 years from the date of convocation are requested to renew their membership by paying fees of Rs. 1000/- (Rs. One Thousand Only) on or before 30th September, 2026, otherwise their names will be removed from electoral roll. The renewal form is made available on our official website www.cpsmumbai.org and/or in the office, during office hours.

All the fellows who have been conferred with fellowship on or before 24th January 2026 are also requested to update their email id, permanent address and mobile number by sending email addressed to Secretary, College of Physicians and Surgeons of Mumbai, CPS house, cpsadmin@cpsmumbai.org on or before 30th September 2026.

All the fellows are further instructed to check in person whether their names are included in the present electoral roll, kept in the office of the Secretary of the College of Physicians and Surgeons of Mumbai, during office hours, at CPS house, Dr. E. Borges road, Parel Mumbai 400 012, from 1st October 2026 to 8th October 2026 during office hours.

Dated: 01-08-2026.

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Force of law

Delhi Police are pursuing protesters, but not acting against their own

The extent and the nature of police action, which continues in Delhi against student protesters, remain a matter of grave concern for India’s democracy. The Supreme Court of India is seized of the matter, but it has done little so far to restrain the police, which appears to be acting outside of the law. To have an independent inquiry that examines the allegations being raised – as is being considered by the Court – is one thing. But an accountable police force would have swiftly acted to preserve its own honour and reputation, considering what is already available in the public domain. Its male officers in uniform appear in videos slapping a woman protester, and attempting to bring down a lathi on the private parts of a girl. The Delhi police is actively pursuing protesters who were apparently present at the protest site, using facial-recognition and other surveillance technologies, the legality of which remains dubious and controversial. Yet, it has offered no response regarding the identity of the officer seen openly assaulting a young woman at a public gathering. The Delhi police would not require any software or Court intervention to identify and hold its own personnel accountable. All it needs is professionalism and a strict adherence to the principle of the rule of law.

There is also a simultaneous law-enforcement sweep against freedom of expression, both online and offline, targeting critics of the government. The police appears eager to proceed against people merely for saying something. Abusive language has indeed been used by some content creators against government functionaries. If any of that warrants police action, the applicable law should be clearly cited, and due process should be followed transparently. Instead, there are reports of arbitrary police action that appears intended more as intimidation than law enforcement, targeting protesters, their families and, in some cases, even social media platforms. At the same time, the police seem uninterested in acting against online mobs that are threatening and abusing the protesters. The Delhi police has maintained that criminals infiltrated the protests. Those involved in violence must certainly be identified and brought to justice in accordance with the law. The force has also not explained the circumstances under which pellets were fired at protesters. Police practices must adhere to established rules and standards, and any breach must be dealt with firmly. This is an occasion for both the Centre and the Court to underscore a basic constitutional principle: nobody, including the police, is above the law. The government should not appear to have gone back on its promises to the agitating students, who called off the protests once their demands were met. That would only entrench cynicism and deepen resentment among the youth who turned up in their thousands at Jantar Mantar.

A healthy tax

The government must act to tax foods high in fat, sugar, and salt

India, which has a long history of addressing the challenges of undernutrition, has to pivot to attack the curious phenomenon of over-nutrition that evolving lifestyles have now laid at its door. The recent National Family Health Survey data showed that in India, while stunting and undernutrition continue to be cause for concern, despite some gains, the sharp rise in adult overweight and obesity, besides diet-related metabolic conditions, cannot be ignored any more. Two unrelated developments have advanced the question of unhealthy diets in very pointed suggestions that would nudge consumers to make the right choices. First, a Parliamentary Standing Committee has recommended mandatory front-of-pack nutrition labelling indicating whether packaged food products are high in sugar, and second, a national consortium has advised the government to levy a health tax on high fat, salt and sugar foods, and enforce stricter regulations on their advertisements. The Standing Committee on Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution also made a recommendation to include the sugar content in baby foods, attacking the excess sugar consumption issue right where it begins. The consortium on adolescent nutrition, which goes by the practical name Let’s Fix Our Food, is led by the Indian Council of Medical Research-National Institute of Nutrition (ICMR-NIN), and comprising several other prominent institutions in India and abroad, has recommended that the government ensure a healthier school food environment, stricter regulation of marketing of unhealthy food, and front-of-pack nutrition labelling. These efforts will be among the steps to tackle the rising burden of obesity and diet-related non communicable diseases that require a comprehensive strategy helmed by the government.

According to the World Health Organization, since 2017, at least 133 countries have increased or introduced a new health tax. A “junk food law” came into force in Colombia in 2023, to tackle the high consumption of packaged foods. An additional tax on such foods began at 10%, rose to 15% the next year and touched 20% the subsequent year. Norway, Hungary, Denmark, Bermuda, Dominica, St. Vincent and the Grenadines, and the Navajo Nation (U.S.), have also specifically implemented taxes on unprocessed sugar and sugar-added foods. With the ICMR-NIN report indicating that over 17 million children and adolescents are affected by obesity, and that this number can cross 27 million by 2030, there cannot be a better time to act on these suggestions that will go a long way in educating the consumer to make healthy food choices.

Gen Z’s voice must lead to a humane education system

With the successful demonstration by the Cockroach Janta Party, a point has been made. A light has been shown in our national darkness. We can use that light, or we can continue to curse the darkness. The choice is always there. Gen Z has pronounced a fiat. It will be wise on our part to take heed. The education system needs not just an overhaul but also a complete change. A change in policy itself. We must now sit down and work out a system in which examinations are seen as fair, conducted professionally, and taken happily and voluntarily. Competitive examinations should no longer be associated with student suicides.

India’s education system has produced extraordinary professional talent, yet its admission culture has also created a dangerous emotional environment in which marks, ranks, and single-shot competitive examinations are often treated as the sole measures of intelligence, worth, and future possibility. This must change.

Examinations need to become more inclusive, projecting students’ worth and abilities even as they assess a candidate’s competence for the chosen field of higher education. Gen Z is very aware of the competitive world it has inherited and is quite capable of making prudent choices for its future. It is up to us – parents, teachers, and policymakers – to consult with them and evolve a system that is fair, robust, and respected.

Assessing competence

A fair system of admission must adopt a multi-dimensional assessment of competence. Admissions should combine moderated school performance, discipline-specific aptitude, analytical writing, structured interviews where appropriate, practical or scenario-based tasks, and verifiable portfolios, projects, internships, community work and co-curricular achievement.

Such an approach would test not only memory and speed but also reasoning, persistence, communication, judgment, ethical orientation and suitability for a chosen field. Entry-level institutions themselves, with the involvement of competent schoolteachers, should design and administer these assessments with transparent criteria and proper safeguards. Examinations should be redesigned to assess application, interpretation and higher-order thinking rather than predictable patterns that feed the coaching industry. This would preserve standards while aligning admissions more closely with real ability, educational purpose and student potential.

Industry, parents, and students must together broaden the meaning of educational success beyond a few high-pressure professional courses. Regular industry interaction through career fairs, internships, mentorship programmes, workplace visits, and alumni engagement can make students aware, even at the school level, of emerging opportunities in newer sectors and reduce blind dependence on competitive examinations for



John Varghese

Former Principal of St. Stephen’s College

traditional career paths. Parents, especially those with limited access to reliable information and who often resort to unaffordable loans, need structured counselling in local languages on courses, careers, costs, scholarships, aptitude, mental-health risks, and the difference between a child’s interests and parental ambitions. Students must be helped to assess their abilities, dispositions, and aspirations realistically through guidance and aptitude-based conversations rather than prestige-driven choices. When informed industry exposure, responsible parental support, and self-aware student decision-making come together, educational choices become more rational, humane, and less fear-driven. This is the groundwork on which a fair and effective entry-level assessment system can be built.

Role of elected representatives

The Constitution treats education as a public good, not a commercial race, and places a clear duty on the state to protect equality, dignity, and the right to education, especially for children and weaker sections. When the coaching ecosystem becomes exploitative – creating inequality, displacing formal schooling, and harming student well-being – Parliament and State legislatures must respond through law, regulation, and oversight. Members of Parliament and Members of the Legislative Assemblies may not be individually liable for a persistent social problem, but they remain institutionally responsible for creating and enforcing safeguards on fees, advertising, mental-health support, hostel standards, and fraudulent practices. In the face of evidence of student suicides and commercialisation, persistent inaction invites democratic and legal scrutiny, making urgent action a constitutional responsibility.

Does one size fit all? No. A centralised agency such as the National Testing Agency rests on the assumption that one examination model can fairly judge all students across disciplines, regions and social contexts; this assumption is flawed – especially in a country such as India, which is varied in every possible way. Institutions and professional bodies are better placed to define what they seek in candidates because they understand the intellectual and academic demands, skills, aptitude and ethical orientation required for specific courses leading to careers. A single national test also creates logistical overload and demographic unfairness: language, geography, school background, digital access, and local educational disadvantages all affect performance, making a “one-test-fits-all” model neither educationally sound nor socially just.

A decentralised system, with universities or clusters of institutions designing and conducting their own assessments within broad University Grant Commission norms, would allow for more relevant and balanced evaluation. Students, too, may be consulted through structured representation in identifying appropriate modes

The time has come to rethink merit, reform admissions, and restore dignity to every student’s academic journey

Western Ghats conservation with science and dialogue

The Western Ghats, spanning six coastal States of India, are internationally recognised for their rich biodiversity. They contain 39 biodiversity hotspot areas, including national parks, reserved forests, and wildlife sanctuaries declared World Heritage Sites (WHS) by UNESCO in 2012. To protect this natural heritage, the Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP) was constituted in 2010 under the chairmanship of ecologist, academic, and writer Madhav Gadgil. Its report recommended declaring 142 talukas covering 44 districts in the entire Western Ghats into Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA), while sub-dividing it into three Ecologically Sensitive Zones (ESZ). Such a declaration would regulate human activities to protect fragile ecosystems and, once notified under the Environment Protection Act, 1986, would provide legal protection.

The ESA journey

Following strong local and political opposition in the States concerned to the WGEEP recommendations, the central government constituted a high-level working group headed by Krishnaswamy Kasturirangan in 2012 to review them. The group limited restrictions on economic activities and livelihoods to ecologically sensitive natural landscapes, reducing the area covered to only 37% of the Western Ghats

Based on this recalibrated report, the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) issued the first draft notification in 2014. Since the matter remained unresolved, the Ministry constituted an expert panel headed by former Director General of Forests Sanjay Kumar in 2022 to examine the concerns raised by the stakeholder States. Following the expert panel’s deliberations, Gujarat and Goa appear to have agreed to the finalisation of the ESA notification, while Maharashtra has sought a fresh review.

Discussions between the Centre and other States, including Karnataka, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu, are ongoing. A “phased rollout” or “State-wise finalisation” is possible after the inclusion of this clause in the 2024 draft notification.



Madhusudan Bandi

Faculty member at the Gujarat Institute of Development Research, Ahmedabad, Gujarat

The case of Karnataka

Karnataka has 10 districts in the Western Ghats, with 23.4% of the State’s population residing there. Around 20,668 square kilometres have been identified for ESA declaration. Regardless of the government’s political affiliation, the State has consistently opposed the proposal, citing its potential impact on agriculture, plantations, mining, and infrastructure development.

A study by this writer covered villages located in the proximity of 10 WHS across four districts – Chikkamagaluru, Kodagu, Shivamogga, and Udupi – and three other important sites in Uttara Kannada and Udupi, including the Kali Tiger Reserve, Mundigekere Bird Sanctuary (five acres and a breeding ground for cattle egrets in Sirsi), and Mookambika Wildlife Sanctuary. The study highlighted local perspectives on livelihoods and conservation efforts.

In villages adjoining the Kali Tiger Reserve and Kudremukh National Park, some residents reported accepting or considering rehabilitation packages. Those opposing relocation felt that they might eventually have to follow due to declining village populations and the resulting threat to village life. Even villages with granted forest rights have faced challenges due to restrictions on minor forest produce collection and agricultural practices. Concerns were also raised over the rejection of forest rights claims by non-tribals with long-standing residence, including in a village (at least 150 years) near the

The Ecologically Sensitive Area debate highlights the need for balanced, inclusive conservation approaches

of assessment, though access to live question papers or confidential content should be strictly avoided. To preserve sanctity and prevent paper leaks, these safeguards are essential: encrypted digital paper transmission; multi-layered question banks with algorithmic randomisation; strict vetting and rotation of paper setters; secure printing and sealed distribution protocols; independent audit and surveillance of examination centres. And severe penal consequences for any breach. Additional safeguards may include biometric candidate verification, time-staggered papers, and post-examination forensic review of anomalies.

Properly scheduled, decentralised examinations spread across the academic calendar would reduce stress, avoid nationwide disruption from a single failure, and permit institutions to test genuine competence and readiness rather than coaching-driven examination technique alone.

Entrance exams should help our students assess themselves for their abilities and competency in a chosen field. Students should undertake the exams willingly, with the clear understanding that it is indeed a competitive world, and that they have a self-worth even beyond the particular exam that they are sitting for. When alternate career choices are there, the pressure on the students is much less; and if they are passionate about a profession, then they will learn to work hard for it.

A humane direction for reform

India requires a shift from rank-based filtration to capacity-based recognition. A just admissions system should ask not only who scored highest under exam pressure, but who has the aptitude, motivation, ethical seriousness, resilience, and capacity to grow in a chosen field. Such a system would still value excellence, but it would define excellence more intelligently and more humanely. Over the past few days, Gen Z has brought us face-to-face with a dark secret we have long lived with: the overemphasis on certain professions. This generation has choices, and we must allow them to choose responsibly while understanding the consequences.

The constitutional promise of education cannot be fulfilled by a structure that rewards fear, debt, and psychological distress while calling the result merit. The alternative lies in holistic assessment, regulation of coaching commercialisation, institutionalised mental-health support, industry involvement, and sustained counselling for parents and students, keeping interests, abilities, and dignity at the centre of educational choices. This will help create happier and more confident young people who choose careers deliberately, not out of compulsion, paving the way for a better India and a better world. If these changes begin now, the suicides caused by entrance examination stress can come to an end.

Balahalli Reserved Forest. Meanwhile, local officials and some communities supported regulating environmentally harmful activities such as stone quarrying and unplanned tourism projects, including proposals for forest ropeways.

With specific reference to the notifications, it must be noted that local communities faced similar restrictions whenever these areas were declared protected zones, even before the WGEEP was constituted. Many residents believe that buffer zones extend 10 kilometres from core areas and fear possible eviction from their lands. Stakeholders across the study districts unanimously expressed concerns that reliance on satellite imagery for identifying ESA areas was unfair, as they were convinced that it could not distinguish plantation crops such as arecanut, shade-grown coffee, rubber, and coconut from forest cover. They also raised concerns that no committees had physically visited their villages.

In this context, Karnataka’s case requires an empathetic approach that addresses genuine stakeholder concerns before a final decision is taken.

Protecting indigenous communities

In the broader context, the Union government’s decision to proceed with the ESA notification for the Western Ghats reflects political will to protect ecology and biodiversity. Conservation efforts cannot be indefinitely delayed as it will result in States losing their control in such areas; ecological systems transcend administrative boundaries.

More importantly, ESA should include indigenous communities living deep within forests, as they naturally follow conservation principles and maintain a sacred, sustainable relationship with the environment despite challenging conditions. Their presence serves as a bridge between forests and mainstream society, while their absence risks the loss of biocultural diversity.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

protection of citizens who speak out against perceived wrongdoing are not separate issues – they are both essential to preserving public trust.

Arathi Krishna S.S., Kollam, Kerala

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

GROUND ZERO



A girl in a village in Madhya Pradesh. A.M. FARUQUI Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

Celebrated at birth, pushed into sex work

Unlike most communities in India, the Banchhadas in M.P. invest more in their daughters' upbringing than in their sons', by giving them better nutrition and clothes, only so that they can force them into sex work and live off their earnings. Branded a 'criminal tribe' by the British and now classified as a Scheduled Caste, the community remains on society's margins as government and NGOs have struggled to break the cycle, reports **Mehul Malpani**

Identities of all sex workers, former sex workers, and their families have been changed to maintain privacy

Sitting in her older daughter's room, where one corner is covered with maps and math formula sheets, Savitri, a 40-year-old former sex worker, recalls when she began hating her profession. "It was when my girls turned five and seven," she says. "I had decided that my daughters would never live the life I had. They would live with dignity."

Although she continued in the profession for a few more years due to family responsibilities – her husband, who was one of her clients, abandoned the family years ago – Savitri eventually quit. Now, about 10 years later, her elder daughter works with an NGO and is preparing to write the police exam, while her younger daughter is preparing for medical entrance tests in Indore.

The family belongs to the Banchhada community, a de-notified tribe with an estimated population of 25,000 spread across 78 villages in the districts of Mandsaur, Neemuch, and Ratlam in western Madhya Pradesh.

Unlike Savitri's daughters, most girls in the community are born into a system in which their families expect them to enter sex work – a practice passed down over generations. According to several members of the community and NGOs in the region, while many Indians celebrate the birth of a boy over a girl, the Banchhadas welcome a girl with sweets and firecrackers. As girls grow up, they receive better nutrition than boys. They are given expensive clothes and, unlike in much of India, are not told that they will have to marry one day and leave the nest.

The reason, however, is disturbing: for generations, the Banchhada girls have been pushed into sex work on hitting puberty and given the responsibility of earning. Their family members function as pimps and live off their money.

Akash Chouhan, founder of the Jan Shaurya Social Welfare and Development Society, an NGO based in Neemuch, estimates that at least 10,000 women of the community, including about 3,000 girls, remain trapped in this form of exploitation. "Girls are forced to drop out of school after Class 8 or 9 and are pushed into sex work by their families," says Akash, who is from the community. "Community elders protect the practice in the name of tradition."

Radhika, a sex worker, says girls are conditioned from childhood to believe in the tradition. They are told it is their responsibility to ease the family's financial woes. "I quit school on my own after Class 9 and began working," she says. "But if a girl refuses to quit, her family forces her into sex work through physical or emotional abuse."

Abuse along the highway

A drive along State Highway 156, which connects the three districts, passes through several villages of the community. Girls wearing bright lipstick stand along the way, while older women sit on cots outside their houses and shanties, watching children playing nearby. As evening approaches, they gesture to men to come in.



Girls are forced to drop out of school after Class 8 or 9 and are pushed into sex work by their families. Community elders protect the practice in the name of tradition.

AKASH CHOUHAN
Founder, Jan Shaurya Social Welfare and Development Society

In Neemuch's Jaitpura village, an elderly woman approaches a car parked on the roadside and asks if anyone would like to come in. She points to three girls sitting outside her house; two of them are her granddaughters. "You can pick either of them and go into the house," she tells them. "It will cost you ₹300 for 10 minutes but I will take ₹100 as my tip. The room has a fan; you will be comfortable."

Most girls along the highway, including those who look underage, say that they are around 20; some say they recently turned 18. Conversations with them reveal that they have been involved in sex work for about four years.

Multiple dhabas along the highway are also involved in brokering deals between prospective clients and sex workers. The owner of a highway dhaba in Ratlam's Dhodar village claims he can "arrange girls" and lists different price brackets based on location, duration, and the girl's age. Standing near a toll booth, he lists the facilities available, including an air-conditioned room, car parking, and assurances of safety from the police. The rates range from ₹300 for 10 minutes, to ₹1,000 for an hour, and ₹6,000 for a night. They go up to ₹10,000 for a younger girl.

"If girls are taken to a hotel, clients face the risk of police raids. But here, clients have no problem," the dhaba owner explains. "The girls avoid going to hotels as they face incidents of violence by drunken men. That is why many of them have built rooms in their houses with AC."

Several sex workers from the region also travel to cities such as Indore in Madhya Pradesh, and Chittorgarh and Udaipur in neighbouring Rajasthan, on client requests.

Shivangi, a former sex worker in Neemuch's Nilkanthpura, who now works with the government's Women and Child Development (WCD) Department, recalls some of the horrific incidents she faced. "In 2003, my friend and I had gone to a hotel in Chittorgarh for two clients. After a few minutes, two or three others entered the room. For hours, we suffered sexual and physical violence that still haunts me. All I could think of was jumping out a window," says Shivangi, who is now married with two daughters.

Shivangi says girls rarely share grim experiences with their families as they have to "get to work as soon as the next client approaches".

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://t.me/+48B98m5PQCF84MmQ9>



A girl with a family member in a district in Madhya Pradesh. A.M. FARUQUI



While the government is running initiatives and programmes to provide these girls livelihood options such as sewing or skill-based jobs, it is difficult to match the income and lifestyle they earn through sex work. This leaves a gap in our efforts to rehabilitate the community

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL

hostels and centres returned to sex work as they had to vacate these places on turning 18. "While the government is running initiatives and programmes to provide them livelihood options such as sewing or skill-based jobs, it is difficult to match the income and lifestyle the girls earn through sex work. This leaves a gap in our efforts to rehabilitate the community," the official adds.

In Mandsaur, however, Garg says the district administration has been able to find a way to issue caste certificates through ancestral records or any fraternal records that can establish a person's connection to their family.

A cycle of exploitation

A recent short film, *Khilawadi*, which has received awards at various national and international film festivals, depicts the story of a Banchhada girl who dreams of becoming a doctor. Made by a debutant filmmaker, Shobhita Thakur, the film's title comes from a local term often used for the oldest daughter of a family, who is not allowed to have a life of her own, whether it is a career or marriage.

In the Banchhada community, dowry is paid by the groom's family to the bride's. The reason is simple: her in-laws compensate her family for lost income. Activists and community members say the amount has increased over the years, with some girls' families even taking ₹25 lakh.

As per the community's customs, a girl cannot marry within the caste once she enters sex work. A married woman is not allowed into sex work.

Sangita, a social worker with Udan Women Employment Welfare Society, explains that the girls are fed ideas against marriage from childhood, and encouraged to get into sex work which promises materialistic benefits such as smartphones, scooters, and clothes. "They tell the girl that if she is unmarried, she can buy whatever she wants, but if she gets married, she will be stuck doing household chores," says Sangita.

After the age of 25, many women are forced to become brokers or offer their houses on commission as client demand begins to decline. Others, suffering from infections, sexually transmitted diseases, or HIV/AIDS, become dependent on relatives or NGOs.

While researching for her film, Shobhita found that a girl suffering from AIDS was in hospital. "The girl's father came to the hospital in a drunken state and asked her to give him money even though she was in a critical condition. He created a scene and left. The girl died a few days later." She says she came across many incidents that were so revolting that she could not include them in the film.

Sex workers say it is because demand goes down with age that they take on as many clients as they can. Radhika says she has about 10-15 clients a day and earns about ₹5,000. "I don't have a large family; I only have my grandmother. So, I have to save enough to buy a house and live comfortably after a few years," she reasons.

Sangita says the girls are unable to escape as caste panchayats punish or penalise those who try to break free from the practice. She adds that the community has an unofficial nexus of pimps and agents that keeps a close watch on the girls, including those who have been rescued.

Garg adds that caste panchayats and community members oppose programmes they believe could affect the profession. "We recently faced resistance during our HPV (human papillomavirus vaccination) drive for cervical cancer as they feared it could impact their girls' work," she says.

A generation of hope

Social activists allege that multiple government campaigns and programmes have failed to impact the community. For instance, the Jabali Scheme launched by the State government remains "completely missing from the ground," Akash says. Launched in the early 1990s, it was aimed at building hostels for the women from the Banchhada and Bedia communities that are involved in caste-based sex work. Officials say there has been no allocation for the scheme for about four years. "Even when it was active, the allocation was just about ₹5 lakh-7 lakh a year for a district," says a WCD official.

Narendra says most government programmes focus on creating awareness instead of providing women with alternative livelihood options and erasing the stigma. "And even their awareness drives often turn into photo opportunities for government officials," he points out.

Meanwhile, NGOs have been running learning centres for children of the community so that they can resist their families' push when the time comes. The youth in various villages also have initiatives to do away with the practice.

In Sagargram, a group of mostly college-going youth formed a committee about four years ago. Within a year, they were able to stop sex work and liquor inside their village. "We faced objections, but we stood our ground," says Vikas Chouhan, a Master of Social Work student.

Saniya, who is part of the committee, says she encouraged a friend, who was being pressured by her family to get into sex work, to fight back. "Her parents came home to complain to my parents, but my parents took my side. My friend fought with her parents. They eventually relented. She is now continuing her studies," she says.

Her approach was simple, Saniya explains. "Start with one house, one person, then move up. Now, our village feels much safer," she says.

Don't threaten Gen Z, you are the past, Rahul tells PM; Kharge seeks Shah's exit



He said attempts at “face-saving” and “image protection” would no longer work as the youth had “already” seen through the government’s actions. He also demanded Mr. Shah’s resignation.

Amid Gen-Z protests, LJP MP moves Bill seeking Commission for Youth



In fact, during the debate over the Public Examinations Amendment Bill, 2026, in the Lok Sabha on July 28 and July 29, Mr. Bharti had advocated certain amendments that were sensitive to students'

As student protests escalated in New Delhi, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced a series of measures, including the creation of fast-track courts and amendments to the Public Examinations Act, 2024. He reached out on Instagram, a platform popular among young people. For the LJP, however, youth anxieties and the Gen-Z protests seemed like they had been brewing for some time, a perception in which the party appeared to differ from the BJP. It is a point that should be taken on board soon.

Mr. Venugopal cited Mr. Singh's statement: "Secondly, it has been repeatedly clarified that no firing took place at all; tear gas was used; so when no fir-



He urged the Speaker to initiate privilege proceedings against Mr. Singh and refer the matter to the Committee of Privileges for examination and necessary action.

Starting August 1, limited copies of this collector's edition will be available exclusively on Zepto across major Indian cities. It is a unique chance to own and hold history in your hands.

Poonawalla updates bio on X without BJP mention

This update comes days after Mr. Poonawalla hinted at his exit from the BJP, saying that the time had come to move on from active politics.

Opposition blames BJP for paper leak in Odisha

Meanwhile, senior Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said that the Congress had consistently maintained – both in 2024 and now in 2026 – that merely prescribing stricter punishments for paper leaks or designating courts as “fast-track” was not enough. “We need a larger and more honest conversation on the commercialisation and corruption in our education system. That was the spirit of the student movement, one which the Modi government must honour,” he said.

GOVERNMENT OF PUDUCHERRY
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HINDU RELIGIOUS & CHARITABLE ENDOWMENTS DEPARTMENT

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Palani Nagar, Palani Taluk, Dindigul District, Tamil Nadu.



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The Temple Administration has decided to sell Tonsured human hair through E-auction sale by MSTC, Ltd. (A Government of India Enterprise) Chennai.

The Human Hair to be sold are as follows:

S.No.	Human Hair Items	Quantity in Kilo.Gram
1.	Item No.I – Above 31” Mudichu 1st Quality (Black)	28.760
2.	Item No.II – From 16” to 30” Mudichu 2nd Quality (Black)	352.100
3.	Item No.III – From 10” to 15” Mudichu 3rd Quality (Black)	181.200
4.	Item No.IV – From 5” to 9” Rubber Hair – 4th Quality (Black)	1305.380
5.	Item No.V – Grey Hair	833.250
6.	Item No.VI – Sadal Hair	195.900
7.	Item No.VII – Gdhr Hair	7.260
8.	Item No.VIII – Below 5” Thukku Hair – 5th Quality (Black)	1000.000

For participating in this E-auction call MSTC Ltd., (SPAT Branch, 37 Floor, No.5, Kodambakkam High Road, Chennai-34. Ph: 0422855000 or visit www.mstccommerce.com, www.mstcindia.co.in, www.palanimanangan.hrcn.tn.gov.in or www.hrcn.tn.gov.in Interested bidders can bid for minimum quantity of 100KG and multiples of 100KGs for any of the items above mentioned in serial numbers 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 and minimum bid quantity 1000 KG for serial number 8. Parties can participate in the E-auction to be held on 31.08.2022 only after completing well in advance the formalities duly prescribed by MSTC, Ltd..

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Engineer Member, BDA on behalf of Bhubaneswar Development Authority, Bhubaneswar invites percentage rate bids in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for civil works as mentioned below :	
1. Nature of works 2. Total No. of works 3. Amount put to tender 4. Class of Contractor 5. Period of Completion 6. Cost of Bid Documents	Development of Patia Urban Park Crematorium side Bhubaneswar. 01 (One) Nos. Rs.3.74 Crore "B" and "A" Class 06 (Six) Calendar months Rs.10,00,00,000 + 18% GST=Rs.11,88,00,000 (Online transfer by the last date & time for receipt of bids) 1% of estimated cost put tender to tender (Online transfer by the last date & time for receipt of bids) From 03.08.2026 to 5.30 PM of 20.08.2026 https://tendersdislo.gva.in. Dt.21.08.2026 at 11.30 AM O/o - Engineer Member, BDA, Bhubaneswar.
7. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) 8. Availability of Tender 9. Date of opening of Tender 10. Place of opening of Tender	Further details can be seen from the website: https://tendersdislo.gva.in . Any addendum / Corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.
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INBRIEF



Two arrested in West Bengal for suspected link to Jaish

A man and a woman have been arrested from Purba Bardhaman district of West Bengal for their suspected association with the Pakistan-based terror outfit Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM). The Special Task Force (STF) of the West Bengal Police arrested the two, identified as Hamim Mondal and Arpita Sarkar, from their rented accommodation in Bardhaman town on Friday. “Both have been in touch with the terror outfit for over a year through social media. We have also seized some electronic devices and documents from them,” said the Inspector-General of the STF, Gaurav Sharma. Investigators are examining whether there was any plan to target Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari.

SC issues notice to Centre on petition to ban polygamy

The Supreme Court on Friday sought the Centre’s response on a petition to declare polygamy among Muslims as unconstitutional, for a direction to take legislative steps to abolish the practice for all citizens regardless of religion. A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant issued notice to the Union government on a petition filed by activist Zakia Soman and others, represented by advocates Shriya Maini and Rajive Maini, for an order to apply Section 82 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), which punishes bigamy, uniformly and by removing any exemptions under Muslim Personal Law. The petitioners contended in court that polygamy was a “primary driver of female destitution”.

India likely to receive below-normal rainfall this month, says IMD

It is predicted to be less than 94% of long period average; the maximum temperatures are expected to stay above normal across most of country

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

India is likely to receive below-normal rainfall during August, with precipitation expected to be less than 94% of the long period average, the India Meteorological Department said on Friday. The forecast also projects below-normal rainfall during the second half of the southwest monsoon season (August-September), although some parts of peninsular India, central, eastern, and northeastern India, and the northern parts of the northwest could receive normal to above-normal rainfall.

Below-normal rainfall in August is likely in many parts of the country, except over much of eastern peninsular India, some parts of northwest and central India, and isolated areas of eastern and northeastern India, where normal to above-normal rainfall is possible.

Maximum temperatures during the month are expected to remain above normal across most of the



Some parts of peninsular India, central, eastern, and northeastern India may receive normal to above-normal rainfall. H. VIBHU Real Creator IAS Edition <https://t.me/+8B98m5PQCF84MmQ9> country, while minimum temperatures are likely to be normal to above normal.

July rain near normal

The IMD also said moderate El Niño conditions over the equatorial Pacific are expected to strengthen through the remainder of the monsoon season, while neutral Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) conditions are likely to persist before a positive IOD develops during September. The latter can help monsoon rain.

For the August-September period as well, the IMD forecast rainfall at below 94% of the long period average, indicating a weaker-

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Cabinet approves scheme to promote ‘floating’ solar plants

The Union Cabinet on Friday approved the Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana, a ₹5,070-crore scheme aimed at accelerating floating solar power by providing central financial assistance of up to ₹1 crore per MW for projects installed on reservoirs and other water bodies.

The programme targets 5,000 MW of floating solar capacity by 2030-31.

The scheme, to be implemented by the Solar Energy Corporation of India, comes at a time when India has about 0.7 GW of installed floating solar capacity despite an estimated potential of 102 GW.

Projects receiving support under the scheme will have to include battery energy storage equivalent to at least two hours, amounting to 10,000 MWh across the programme, to help States meet peak demand and reduce the curtailment of renewable power during periods of excess generation.

India’s flagship project, the Omkareshwar floating solar park, located on the Narmada in Madhya Pradesh’s Khandwa district is the country’s largest at 278 MW, with plans to scale to 600 MW output. However,



The programme targets 5,000 MW of floating solar capacity by 2030-31.

it doesn’t have onsite battery storage.

Officials said the financial support was intended to “nudge” the industry to develop an alternative stream of solar capacity. Solar development in India has remained concentrated in Rajasthan and Gujarat because of their vast tracts of inexpensive land and high solar radiation.

Reservoir-based projects are expected to “diversify” installations, particularly in States with large water bodies but limited land availability.

The policy is also designed to address two of the biggest constraints facing ground-mounted solar projects: acquiring large contiguous parcels of land and the rising costs associated with rehabilitation and resettlement.

Plea alleges irregularities in IAF land acquisition

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Gauhati High Court has sought responses from the Defence Ministry, the Indian Air Force (IAF), the Mizoram government, and two private persons on a public interest litigation (PIL) petition alleging irregularities in the acquisition of land for an IAF establishment near Lengpui in Mizoram and the disbursal of nearly ₹198.79 crore in compensation.

On July 27, a Division Bench comprising Justices Michael Zothankhuma and Budi Habung issued notices after hearing the plea filed by the Citizen Alliance for Truth and Justice (CA-TAJ), a registered society, and Rev. Zaidarhzaupa.

The petition challenges the acquisition of about 110 bighas of land at Lengpui village for an IAF administrative establishment and alleges that compensation was paid to individuals who were not the lawful landowners.

According to the petitioners, compensation arising from the acquisition of seven Land Settlement Certificates (LSCs) was disbursed to respondents Rohmingliana and Henry Lahremsanga Hlawmual, even though they were not the actual landowners.

Taslima Nasrin returns to Kolkata after 19 years, BJP welcomes her

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Exiled Bangladeshi writer Taslima Nasrin on Friday returned to Kolkata after a gap of almost 19 years. The author was welcomed by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), with party MLA from Dum Dum North Assembly constituency, Sourav Sikdar, present at the Kolkata airport to receive her.

Ms. Nasrin will participate in an event at Rabin-dra Sadan here on Saturday, where West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari is likely to be present. “I am feeling very happy to return,” the author told reporters at the airport. Dressed in a white saree with a red border, traditionally worn by women in West Bengal, Ms. Nasrin was greeted with the blowing of conch shells



Bangladeshi writer Taslima Nasreen speaks to the media at Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport in Kolkata on Friday. ANI

outside the airport.

During her recent interactions with media outlets, the 63-year-old Bengali writer had said that returning to West Bengal was like returning to her own country. “West Bengal has never been divided in my heart by a border or a barbed-wire fence. The door to the eastern part of

Bengal remains closed to me, so for now, this part of Bengal is my home,” she had said.

Ms. Nasrin had to leave Kolkata in November 2007, when violence erupted in the city after some organisations called for action against the author over her writings. The violence reached such alarming

proportions that the Army had to be deployed to contain the situation.

West Bengal Minister Agnimitra Paul described Ms. Nasrin’s return as a significant cultural moment.

Ms. Nasrin started staying in Kolkata after her exile from Bangladesh in 1994 over her writings on women’s rights and Islamic fundamentalism. She had criticised the Left Front and the Trinamool Congress governments for not allowing her to return to West Bengal in the past two decades.

While former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee had not commented on the author’s return, CPI(M) leaders said that the Left Front government did not force Ms. Nasrin out but that the law and order situation had taken a violent turn.

‘T.N. govt. must increase floor-to-floor height to promote luxury housing’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Developers in the luxury segment have urged the Tamil Nadu government to increase the floor-to-floor height limit in the Third Master Plan to promote luxury housing in Chennai.

Speaking at the session on “Luxury housing boom: How architecture is redefining premium living” at *The Hindu* Real Estate and Urban Infrastructure Summit, 2026 on Thursday, Kruthivas, Managing Director of Pushkar Properties, said the ceiling height in luxury homes had been reduced to nine feet because of a 10-foot floor-to-floor height restriction.

“Luxury housing developers have demanded an increase in floor-to-floor height. The luxury market in Chennai is an end-user-driven market. Chennai is



Faisal Manzur, Founder and Principal Architect, Faisal Manzur Design Studio; Kruthivas, MD, Pushkar Properties Pvt. Ltd.; Deepak Jawahar, Architect and Co-Founder, The Architecture Story; Sruti Reddy, Principal Architect and Creative Director, Ceebros Design Works, at panel discussion moderated by Sangeetha Kandavel, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*, at The Hindu Real Estate and Urban Infrastructure Summit, 2026. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

not moving towards luxury to show off; it is moving towards having a better lifestyle. There are fundamental issues that the government has to look at. The government always looks at it from one angle: ‘What if people violate the rules?’” he said.

Sruti Reddy, Principal

Architect and Creative Director, Ceebros Design Works, said: “Chennai is a conservative end-user market. There has been a significant shift in the luxury real estate segment, especially after the COVID-19 pandemic. If you look at other Indian cities, the luxury and ultra-luxury seg-

ments have surpassed the mid-segment in terms of sales value.”

She added that approvals for real estate projects had become faster after the new government took office.

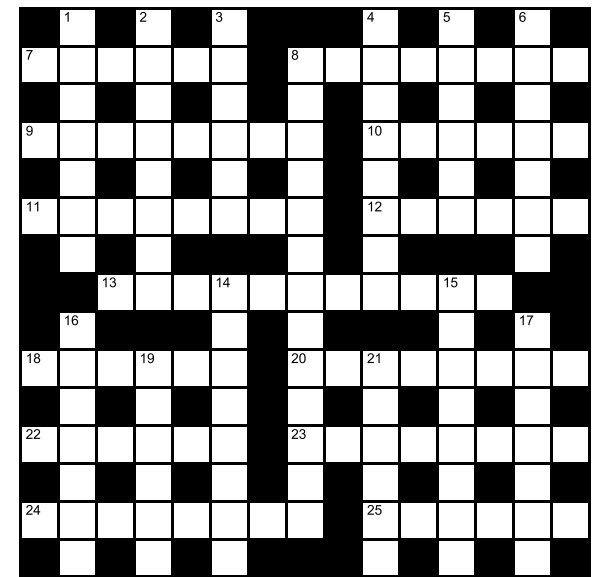
The session was moderated by Sangeetha Kandavel, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*. The Real Estate and Infrastructure Summit, 2026 was presented by Casagrand in association with Adissia Developers. The event was supported by Associate Partners: Navin’s and Mindspace REIT; Banking Partner: State Bank of India; Insurance Partner: United India Insurance; Academic Partner: Saveetha College of Architecture & Design; Industry Partner: CREDAI Chennai; Television Partner: Puthiya Thalaimurai; and Digital News Partner: The Federal.

THE CROSSWORD+ 14861

(set by Pixie Dust)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY



- Across
- 7 Air bubbles from damaged mobile (6)
 - 8 Not the first meal with short, sweet punch (8)
 - 9 Disreputable persons repeatedly using a fir! (8)
 - 10 Independent male left foreign trade (6)
 - 11 Disgusted Tom Cruise abandoning one user (8)
 - 12 Grandpa youthfully concealing distribution of money (3,3)

- 13 Feverish pirate uses soft wipes (6,5)
 - 18 High (from the beginning) she heard repetitive, incessant, loud litany (6)
 - 20 Is this type of wooden case destroying aesthetics? (3,5)
 - 22 Guard briefly thwarting initial attempt to split the eardrums (6)
 - 23 Spooner's dignity, lure and interest perhaps? (4,4)
 - 24 Naughty Alice smothering mother and Herb (8)
 - 25 Colfax mopes every now and then for fixes! (6)
- Down
- 1 Wicked rascal acknowledged dues (7)
 - 2 Jerk cycling around often shredded pieces of coloured paper (8)
 - 3 Please lay down weapons (6)
 - 4 Ape a plant? (5-3)
 - 5 Stupid doctor, mainly ignorant, pathetic and extremely prickly (6)
 - 6 Nearly upset bowl on top containing copper in the univalent state (7)
 - 8 Notable Battle of Rugen, perhaps (13)
 - 14 Resentment carried out without a bit of emotion's amazing! (8)
 - 15 True! The reality is exposing something exquisite! (8)
 - 16 Backtracking, loathe the tailing revolutionary animal (7)
 - 17 ...that is describing very elevated form of element (7)
 - 19 Some werewolf nimbly reversing tide (6)
 - 21 Intermittently alarming, fierce bait for Leopard's-Banel (6)

SUDOKU

	4			9		1		
3				6	5			
	1	2						9
		1					2	
			3	5	6	7	9	
	5						8	
8							3	4
				2	8			1
		9		3			8	

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

6	7	3	2	9	8	1	5	4
9	8	4	1	6	5	2	7	3
2	1	5	4	7	3	9	8	6
8	2	1	9	4	6	5	3	7
7	3	9	5	8	1	6	4	2
5	4	6	7	3	2	8	9	1
1	5	7	3	2	9	4	6	8
4	6	2	8	5	7	3	1	9
3	9	8	6	1	4	7	2	5

Business

INBRIEF



SEBI clarifies on off-market sale of unlisted shares

Markets regulator SEBI on Friday said the off-market sale of unlisted equity shares by an existing shareholder through private negotiations will not be treated as a deemed public issue, provided the number of purchasers does not exceed the statutory limit of 200 persons in a financial year. SEBI said these transactions are secondary transfers by an existing shareholder and do not constitute an offer or invitation by the company to subscribe to securities. PTI

Apple posts record June quarter revenue of \$ 109.4 bn

Tech giant Apple has posted record June quarter revenue of \$109.4 billion, up 16% on a year-on-year basis, supported by double-digit growth in most emerging markets including India, but flagged business risks in the next few quarters due to rising memory chip prices and supply constraints, according to a top company official. The company's gross margin was 50.1%, including a favourable impact of approximately 2 percentage points from tariff refunds. PTI

'Adani Energy plans another share sale by early next fiscal'

India's Adani Energy Solutions may launch another share sale for institutional investors by early next fiscal year, after securing ₹35 billion (about \$367 million) in a similar fundraise this week, two sources familiar with the matter said on Thursday. Companies belonging to billionaire Gautam Adani's ports-to-power conglomerate have raised about \$4.75 billion over the last eight months through QIPs and rights issues to fund expansion and reduce debt. REUTERS

TTK Prestige eyes growing faster than market: MD & CEO

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

TTK Prestige, a Bengaluru-based kitchen appliances maker, said the brand was poised to grow faster than the market and would continue to position itself in the premium segment.

"As we continue to position Prestige at the premium end of the market, our endeavour is to grow faster than the market and sustain that momentum," said

Venkatesh Vijayaraghavan, MD & CEO, TTK Prestige.

He said the firm is focused on strengthening market leadership through continued investments in innovation, premium products, retail expansion, and consumer-centric growth initiatives.

In QIFY27, it's net profit almost doubled year on year to ₹66.4 crore. Revenue at ₹771.4 crore represented a 34.2% growth for the company.

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Indian Oil Corporation Ltd. (IOCL) has crude oil supplies secured for the entirety of August and most of September, Arvinder Singh Sahney, Chairman of the State-owned oil marketing company told reporters on Friday.

"We are comfortably placed with crude oil supplies till August and most of September, which is about 45 to 50 days," Mr. Sahney stated.

State-owned oil marketing companies (OMCs) sought to shield prices of retail petroleum products Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

notwithstanding the conflict in Asia which marred shipping across the Strait of Hormuz and elevated crude oil prices.

The Delhi-headquartered refiner posted a net loss of ₹2,661 crore in the June-ended quarter.

Peers post loss

Peers Hindustan Petroleum and Bharat Petroleum also incurred net loss of about ₹12,265 crore and ₹3,962 crore respectively, during the same period.

Indian Oil Corp.'s overall revenues rose 26% on a year-on-year basis to about ₹2.76 lakh crore.

Mr. Sahney attributed the narrower-than-anti-



Indian Oil also posted its lowest-ever quarterly fuel and loss of 8.04% in the post Bharat Stage-VI scenario. REUTERS

pated net loss to the refinery's operational efficiencies. "We were able to navigate through the period because of the physical performance of our as-

sets and their capabilities," the chairman said.

The company's refinery throughput stood at 19.165 million metric tonnes (MMT) harbouring capaci-

Centre extends PM-Kisan for four more years, allocates ₹3.15 lakh cr.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet on Friday approved continuation of the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) Scheme from 2026-27 to 2030-31, with a total financial outlay of ₹3.15 lakh crore.

The scheme provides a financial assistance of ₹6,000 per year for farmers. The government said it had transferred more than ₹4.47 lakh crore directly to farmers' bank accounts in 23 instalments under the scheme which was

The govt. had transferred over ₹4.47 lakh crore to farmers' accounts in 23 instalments

launched in February 2019. "Under the 23rd instalment, more than 9.49 crore farmers benefited, with over ₹18,984 crore released," the Union Agriculture Ministry said in a release.

Women beneficiaries

The government added that women farmers had

received more than ₹1.06 lakh crore under PM-KISAN, and nearly one out of every four beneficiary was a woman farmer.

"The assistance provided under PM-KISAN has enabled farmers to make timely investments in seeds, fertilizers, irrigation, agricultural machinery and other agricultural requirements. This has enhanced farmers' productive capacity, reduced their dependence on informal credit and strengthened the financial stability of rural households," the Ministry added.

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Maruti Suzuki India Ltd. (MSIL), India's biggest passenger vehicle (PV) manufacturer, reported an 11% decline in Q1 net profit to ₹3,352 crore from ₹3,758 crore in the year-ago period on high material cost. Net sales income increased 36% YoY to ₹49,959 crore.

"Material costs had started to increase in the quarter and were seriously aggravated during the war, as a result of which the net profit was impacted," the company said.



Domestic small car sales grew by 34.1%, SUVs by 44.6%, and exports by 28.6%. REUTERS

Total sales volume grew 29.3% YoY. Domestic small car sales grew by 34.1%, SUVs by 44.6%, and exports by 28.6%.

Domestic market share

pursue diversification "as much as possible".

Seeking to shield consumers from the impact of global price surge, Indian Oil incurred under recoveries of ₹720 per cylinder in June and ₹503 per cylinder in July.

Separately, officials also informed that Indian Oil Corporation had tapped into the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) credit facility swap window to raise \$500 million.

The facility seeks to offer concessional swaps for fresh FNCR (B) deposits, external commercial borrowings (ECBs) and overseas foreign currency borrowings (OCBs).

Maruti Suzuki Q1 net falls 11% to ₹3,352 cr. on high material cost

TTK Prestige eyes growing faster than market: MD & CEO

SC upholds NCLAT order setting aside CCI's ₹301.6-cr. Grasim fine

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court upheld a NCLAT order that set aside a ₹301.6 crore penalty imposed on Grasim Industries by the Competition Commission of India (CCI) and directed the fair trade regulator to hear the Aditya Birla Group firm again over alleged dominance in the viscose staple fibre market.

A bench comprising Justices J. B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran dismissed the Competition Commis-



A view of the Supreme Court in New Delhi.

sion of India's (CCI) appeal challenging the May 5 NCLAT order.

The tribunal had obser-

vedt the CCI did not provide a chance to Grasim Industries to present its arguments after it differed from the findings of the Director General (DG), the regulator's probe unit.

The CCI had imposed the penalty on Grasim Industries in March 2020 for allegedly abusing its dominant position with respect to the supply of viscose staple fibre (VSF) to spinners.

Grasim challenged the order before NCLAT which "set aside the impugned order and remanded it back to the Commission."

NSE pays ₹714.74 crore to settle case of co-location

rust of India
NEW DELHI

National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) said it has paid ₹714.74 crore to SEBI after receiving the regulator's in-principle approval to settle the long-pending colocation and dark fibre cases for ₹1,491.21 crore.

The latest payment, together with ₹776.47 crore already deposited by NSE, completes ₹1,491.21-crore settlement agreed under revised settlement terms.

Bengaluru gets first tariff-free Scottish salmon via U.K.FTA

Nagesh Prabhu
BENGALURU

Bengaluru received the first tariff-free shipment of Scottish salmon to India under the U.K.-India Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), marking one of the earliest commercial outcomes of the trade pact.

Owen Richards, Deputy Head of Mission at the British Deputy High Commission here, formally re-

ceived the shipment at the premises of Sashimi Foods Pvt. Ltd. on Friday

The consignment comprised freshly farmed Scottish salmon produced by Bakkafrost Scotland.

The CETA eliminated India's earlier 33% import tariff on Scottish salmon. Industry estimates the CETA could generate up to £130 million in additional export opportunities for Scotland's salmon sector over the next decade.

Cabinet okays ₹84,084-cr. Samudra Manthan for offshore exploration

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

To boost India's offshore exploration efforts, the Union Cabinet approved an outlay of ₹84,084 crore to the Union Petroleum Ministry's National Offshore Exploration Scheme Samudra Manthan.

The corpus is to be utilised until FY2030-31. The overall outlay is categorised into four key components the most important of which relate to drilling 60 deepwater exploration wells for which the Cabinet has allocated ₹43,200 crore.

This is inclusive of the government of up to 50% of eligible drilling cost or ₹675 crore per well.

The other component relates to offshore data acquisition which carries an outlay of ₹28,534 crore.

Development of common offshore infrastruc-



Well oiled plan: The scheme aims at catalysing reserves of over 600 MMTOE. (For representational purpose only) GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCK Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+48B98m5PQCF84MmQ9

Overall, the government's flagship scheme for offshore exploration aims at catalysing reserves of more than 600 million metric tonnes of oil equivalent (MMTOE).

Stimulating investments It envisages to "stimulate significant investments across the exploration and production value chain, creating long-term oppor-

tunities for industry, innovation and economic growth."

Essentially, with hydrocarbon exploration being a capital-intensive activity with long gestation period but essential for a country's domestic energy security, the scheme seeks to reorient growth into this sector (via offshore exploration) to overcome difficulties from ageing oil and gas fields.

Reflecting on the announcement, Rajnish Gupta, partner for tax and economic policy, EY India held, "Investments in large-scale seismic data acquisition and drilling of exploratory well in deep and ultra deep waters will reduce geological uncertainty and de-risk exploration and lay the foundation for future discoveries. Good results can catalyse greater private investments in the sector."

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाग, अजमेर
क्रमांक : अमुअ/अज /वक /एक-2(300)निविदा/डी-1280 दिनांक 27/07/2026
निविदा सूचना संख्या 16 वर्ष 2026-2027
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से **पोर्टफोलियो असेसमेंट पद्धति** के अनुसार सड़क, सी. डी. एवं पुल निर्माण कार्यों हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं केन्द्रीय/राज्य सरकार व उनके अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/हाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग/रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के विभिन्न श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निर्धारित प्रणय में कुल 06 पैकेज/कार्यों, जिनकी कुल लागत राशि रु. 2613.63 लाख है, के लिए ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदाये आमंत्रित की जाती है।
निविदा फार्म डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड दिनांक 29 जुलाई, 2026 को प्रातः 9.30 बजे से करने की तारीख एवं समय दिनांक 20 अगस्त, 2026 को सायं 6.00 बजे तक।
निविदा से संबंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाईट www.diprcrajasthan.gov.in पर एवं निविदा दस्तावेज का विवरण वेबसाईट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raaj.nic.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन सम्पादित की जावेगी।
NIB No.- PWD2627A1810
UBN No.- PWD2627WSOB07656 PWD2627WSLOB07657
PWD2627WSOB07658 PWD2627WSOB07659
PWD2627WSOB07660 PWD2627WSOB07661
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सा.नि.वि. संभाग, अजमेर।
डीआईपीआर/सी/13225/2026

MANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(Government of Karnataka undertaking)
Corporate Office, MESCOM Bhavana, Bejai, Mangaluru-575 004
Phone: 0824-2885795 CIN: U40109 KA 2002 SGC 030425
No. E-342140 Date: 28.07.2026
TENDER NOTIFICATION (THROUGH KPP PORTAL ONLY)
MESCOM invites tender for Procurement of following material:

Tender No	Name of the Material proposed for Procurement	Quantity
MESCOM/2026-27/IND0166	Safety Hand Gloves	3500 Pairs

The interested eligible bidders may log on to www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in on or after **01.08.2026**.
Sd/-
DIPR/DK/MP/L/605/26-27 Superintending Engineer (Ele), (Procurement)
For Power Related Complaints contact:
MESCOM Helpline: 1912
☎ 9483041912 f mescom_official xmescom_official

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LTD., VS, VIJAYAWADA-520004 (A Govt. of A.P Undertaking)
NIT/RFX No:510000307
Name of the work: "Procurement of steel material required for Dr.MVR RTPP for the year 2026-27" through e-procurement. Schedule available Date & Time: 29.07.2026 - 18.00 Hrs onwards. Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 19.08.2026 - 15.00 Hrs For other details visit the website www.apgccgo.gov.in (or) <https://tender.apgccgo.gov.in/irj/portal>. Phone: (0866) 2526446, 2526455. DIPR 5259PPICL Dt: 31/07/2026

OFFICE OF ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, WATER RESOURCES ZONE, UDAIPUR
Near Akashvani, Chetak Circle, Udaipur (Rajasthan) 313001
Phone no.: 0294-2414794 Email:- aceudaipur2019@gmail.com
No.- ACE/Act.-II/IF / 2026-27/2548 Dated:- 22/07/2026
E-NIT No. 03/2026-27
NIB COD- WRD267A0190
Bids for the following work are invited from interested bidders upto 6:00 PM, dated 17-08-2026.

S. No.	Name of Work	Estimated. Cost of Work (Rs. in lacs)
1	Rehabilitation of Dam and Repair and new construction work of Canals, Asind-Hurda (Asind), Bhilwara	844.08

Other particulars of bid may be visited on the Procurement portal <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>, www.dipr.rajasthan.gov.in & www.water.rajasthan.gov.in/nwr
UBN No :- WRD2627WLOB00412 Additional Chief Engineer
DIPRC/13152/2026 Water Resources Zone, Udaipur

SRI VENKATESWARA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES: TIRUPATI
(A University established by an Act of A.P. State Legislature)
TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tenders are invited through e-tendering process in ap-e-procurement platform (Two bid System) for
(I) Purchase of Medical Equipment:
(a) Short period e-tender notice for ICMR-IRDL project items - 3 nos.
(b) Regular period e-tender for rest of the equipment
(II) Network accessories on rate contract basis and maintenance of SVIMS Network infrastructure for a period of two years.
(III) Limited e-tender under the two-bid system from eligible NABL-accredited diagnostic laboratories located within a 5 km radius of SVIMS for outsourcing laboratory investigations required for patient services at SVIMS for a period of two (2) years (2026-2028).
For ICMR - IRDL project items, tender will be published in online immediately and for rest of the items tenders will be published in days.
For details log on to the website <https://tender.approcurement.gov.in> & <https://svimstpt.ap.nic.in>
The Director-cum-VC reserves the right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason whatsoever.
DONATE LIBERALLY TO "SVIMS GENERAL DONATION SCHEME" SVIMS ACCOUNT No: 62121045670, SBI IFSC CODE: SBIN0020926, "80G BENEFITS AVAILABLE TO THE SCHEME"
Roc.No, P1/19/e-procurement/PD/SVIMS/10 Date: 29.07.2026 **DIRECTOR-CUM-VC.**

34 miners killed in a methane blast at coal mine in southwestern Pak.



U.S. lawmaker urges Taiwan to pass drone Bill, warning ‘time is short’



Nepalese climber among six still missing after Pakistan avalanche



Italy suspends Schengen pact with Spain for one month from today



'India risks complicity in Israel's war crimes in Gaza'

Trump mulls \$100,000 fee for students keen to work in the U.S. after graduation

Jamshedpur pulls out of Indian Super League

develop the game of football, including at the grassroots levels. We will continue to identify and develop young football talent across India to create a strong pathway for players from grassroots to national and international football,” JFC said in a statement.

The Red Miners made their ISL debut in 2017-18 and finished fifth in two consecutive seasons. After a disappointing 2019-20 campaign, Owen Coyle was appointed manager, and under the Scotsman, it became only the third club – after FC Goa and Mumbai City FC – to win the League Winners’ Shield.

Owned and managed by Tata Steel, JFC was the only club in the Indian topflight to own its stadium and training facilities.

Abhinandh flicks mental switch, lights up Ultimate Table Tennis

The 18-year-old's fearless aggression and tactical awareness brought him success in Season 7 of the league. The performance, coming as it did as he begins the transition to the senior ranks, showed he has the technical ability and temperament to succeed at the highest level



BUTTERFLY UTT

K. Keerthivasan

It was the grand inaugural match of Ultimate Table Tennis Season 7 in Panaji. The flashlights were bright sweeping across the indoor arena, and the official UTT anthem blared through the speakers.

Upending the status quo

Amidst the maddening noise, the lights and the spectacle emerged two paddlers. There was, however, nothing particularly spectacular about the match-up on paper. One was ranked in the 200s, the other inside the world's top 50.

But what unfolded over the next few minutes was spectacular. P.B. Abhinandh, 18, representing Dempo Goa Challengers, was the challenger with everything to prove. Across the table stood defending champion U Mumba's Lilian Bardet – a 25-year-old with deep runs in several WTT Pro Tour events and a silver at the 2024 World championships with the French men's team.

More than that, Bardet, the then World No. 42, is an uber-aggressive player on both wings, with the game and the experience to trouble anyone. Yet, the manner in which Abhinandh, then ranked 210, drubbed him in three straight games underlined the teenager's growing prowess.

The Chennai-based paddler served smartly,



I'm no longer afraid to go for my shots and back myself. I play without fear. Playing with seniors in UTT has certainly been beneficial

ABHINANDH

even if there weren't too many variations. More often than not, he rushed Bardet with quick serves directed either to the extreme backhand or into the body, denying the Frenchman the time to settle into his attacking rhythm.

The defining feature of the victory, however, was Abhinandh's powerful forehand topspin. Time and again, he overpowered Bardet with ferocious forehand winners from behind the table. Whenever Bardet dropped the ball short or kept his serve short, Abhinandh was quick to pounce, either setting up the point with a deep push that forced Bardet out of position or finishing it outright with a clean winner, all without losing his balance over the table.

The manner of victory thrust the spotlight firmly on the youngster. Under such unforgiving lights, many would have crumbled. Abhinandh didn't. He continued to string together wins with the same fearless aggression and sharp tactical awareness, including one over Ankur Bhattacharjee – widely regarded as one of India's brightest prospects. His unbeaten run ended against Egypt's Omar Assar, UTT's highest-ranked player at World No. 35. Yet even in defeat, Abhinandh left a lasting impression.

The teenager starred in his team's march to the final, where he again defeated Bardet in the opening match. U Mumba came back to win the

title, but Abhinandh had done enough over the course of the tournament to be named Season 7's Player of the League.

Clearly, he is no ordinary talent.

Ranked World No. 13 in the youth (u-19) category, Abhinandh is slowly beginning his transition to the senior circuit. In fact, he has competed in just three senior WTT tournaments this year and is expected to play a few more.

What explains the transformation witnessed during UTT?

Abhinandh says it is the result of a conscious change in approach after several discussions with his coach, Subin Kumar, at the Chennai Achievers TT Academy.

"Compared to the standards at which I played in the WTT Youth and WTT Feeder events, there has definitely been a major difference in my game. Beating players like Bardet, Payas [Jain], Ankur and Youssef [Abdelaziz] doesn't happen every day. WTT is a different atmosphere, while UTT, played at home, is played over the best-of-three format where anything can happen.

"More importantly, there has been a shift in my mentality. I'm no longer afraid to go for my shots and back myself. I play without fear. Playing with seniors in UTT has certainly been beneficial," Abhinandh says.

One of the common criticisms of many Indian

STACKING UP



ATP Men's Top 15

#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Jannik Sinner	24	13,450	17
2	Alexander Zverev	29	8,480	20
3	Carlos Alcaraz	23	8,160	17
4	Felix Auger-Aliassime	25	4,740	23
5	Novak Djokovic	39	3,760	15
6	Alex de Minaur	27	3,660	23
7	Daniil Medvedev	30	3,620	23
8	Ben Shelton	23	3,580	21
9	Flavio Cobolli	24	3,420	26
10	Taylor Fritz	28	3,300	21
11	Alexander Bublik	29	2,525	26
12	Jiri Lehecka	24	2,470	20
13	Casper Ruud	27	2,435	22
14	Andrey Rublev	28	2,420	23
15	Lorenzo Musetti	24	2,315	21

Top Indians ▶



Sumit Nagal
Rank 246 ▼ 16 spots



Dhakshinewar Suresh
Rank 353 ▲ 83 spots

WTA Women's Top 15

#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Aryna Sabalenka	28	8,550	18
2	Elena Rybakina	27	8,056	21
3	Jessica Pegula	32	6,300	18
4	Coco Gauff	22	5,649	18
5	Mirra Andreeva	19	5,293	20
6	Karolina Muchova	29	5,168	20
7	Linda Noskova	21	5,016	21
8	Iga Swiatek	25	4,539	19
9	Amanda Anisimova	24	4,353	15
10	Elina Svitolina	31	4,351	16
11	Marta Kostyuk	24	3,925	16
12	Victoria Mboko	19	3,520	21
13	Naomi Osaka	28	3,086	17
14	Belinda Bencic	29	2,845	18
15	Jasmine Paolini	30	2,783	19

Top Indians ▶



Sahaja Yamalapalli
Rank 343 ▲ 6 spots



Vaishnavi Adkar
Rank 382 ▼ No change

F1 Drivers' standings

#	Driver	Team	Points	Wins
1	A.K. Antonelli	Mercedes	219	6
2	L. Hamilton	Ferrari	169	1
3	G. Russell	Mercedes	160	2
4	C. Leclerc	Ferrari	138	1
5	L. Norris	McLaren	128	1
6	M. Verstappen	Red Bull	109	0
7	O. Piastri	McLaren	92	0
8	I. Hadjar	Red Bull	68	0
9	L. Lawson	RB	43	0
10	P. Gasly	Alpine	42	0
11	A. Lindblad	RB	23	0
12	F. Colapinto	Alpine	19	0
13	O. Bearman	Haas	18	0
14	G. Bortoletto	Audi	10	0
15	C. Sainz	Williams	6	0
16	A. Albon	Williams	5	0
17	E. Ocon	Haas	3	0
18	N. Hulkenberg	Audi	2	0
19	F. Alonso	Aston Martin	1	0
20	V. Bottas	Cadillac	0	0
21	S. Perez	Cadillac	0	0
22	L. Stroll	Aston Martin	0	0



A.K. Antonelli



L. Hamilton

F1 Constructors' standings

Pos	Team	Points	Wins
1	Mercedes	379	8
2	Ferrari	307	2
3	McLaren	220	1
4	Red Bull	177	0
5	RB	66	0
6	Alpine	61	0
7	Haas	21	0
8	Audi	12	0
9	Williams	11	0
10	Aston Martin	1	0
11	Cadillac	0	0

Badminton Men's ranking

#	Player	Points	Events
1	Shi Yu Qi	94,255	12
2	Kunlavut Vitidsarn	91,215	16
3	Jonatan Christie	89,231	17
4	Anders Antonsen	87,705	17
5	Christo Popov	87,002	20
6	Chou Tien Chen	84,280	26
7	Victor Lai	77,045	19
8	Li Shi Feng	70,483	16
9	Alex Lanier	70,215	16
10	Kodai Naraoka	70,030	20
11	Alwi Farhan	69,419	19
12	Lin Chun-Yi	69,374	18
13	Loh Kean Yew	66,300	20
14	Lakshya Sen	65,573	21
15	Toma Junior Popov	62,697	20

Top Indians ▶



Lakshya Sen
Rank 14



Ayush Shetty
Rank 22

Badminton Women's ranking

#	Player	Points	Events
1	An Se Young	1,17,787	15
2	Akane Yamaguchi	1,04,576	18
3	Wang Zhi Yi	1,02,689	16
4	Chen Yu Fei	91,451	15
5	Han Yue	77,038	14
6	Putri Kusuma Wardani	76,473	18
7	Ratchanok Intanon	74,606	20
8	Tomoka Miyazaki	68,106	22
9	P.V. Sindhu	67,601	14
10	Pornpawee Chochuwong	66,727	16
11	Nozomi Okuhara	60,310	18
12	Kim Ga Eun	59,731	16
13	Michelle Li	55,227	21
14	Sim Yu Jin	55,084	20
15	Line Christophersen	54,060	21

Top Indians ▶



P.V. Sindhu
Rank 9



Unnati Hooda
Rank 28



I always knew he was a big-stage player who loves competition, so what he has done in UTT hasn't come as a surprise to me

SUBIN KUMAR
Coach

juniors is that, under the guidance of their coaches, they continue to focus heavily on junior and youth events instead of making an early switch to the senior circuit. This, critics argue, often hinders their development.

Abhinandh, however, disagrees with the notion that youngsters should abandon the junior circuit altogether. According to him, becoming a top-five junior in the world is an achievement of immense value and should not be dismissed. What matters, he believes, is ensuring that the transition to the senior ranks is well-planned.

He cites examples to buttress his arguments. "Take Harimoto Tomokazu for example. He gradually quit playing in juniors after he won the ITTF World juniors at 13. China's Ma Long was 16 when he won the ITTF World juniors in 2004. Ryusei Kawakami, who won the World youth u-19 title last year, hasn't played much in juniors. The shift should be gradual and if it is done abruptly it will affect the confidence of young players."

Immediate focus

The teenager says his aim is to reach the top-4 in the youth section over the next year before shifting his attention to the seniors completely.

Subin Kumar, an ITTF-certified coach who has worked with Abhinandh since the youngster was five years old, says the breakthrough did not come overnight.

"I started preparing him for a proper transition to the senior level, and there were plenty of ups and downs. We began working on his transition two years ago, focusing not just on his game but also on the mental and physical aspects. I always knew he was a big-stage player who loves competition, so what he has done in UTT hasn't come as a surprise to me," Subin says.

The coach believes the next phase of Abhinandh's development involves regular exposure to the senior international circuit.

"He hasn't played many senior WTT tournaments so far, but this year and next year he will compete in more senior events. The idea is that by the time he graduates from the youth circuit, the transition to the senior level will be much smoother. We are still working on his fitness and the mental side of the game," he adds.

Dempo Goa Challengers coaches Elena Timina and Parag Agrawal, who have watched Abhinandh closely, echo Subin's assessment. They believe the teenager has the maturity to take responsibility for his own development.

"He has his feet firmly on the ground, listens well and is a very clever boy. He has a clear idea of what he wants to do on the table. The main area he needs to improve is his physical fitness," Timina says. Parag believes Abhinandh has struck the right balance between junior and senior competition. "He has planned his junior and senior careers well. He's playing an adequate number of tournaments in both categories and is very disciplined," he says.

The next two to three years will be decisive. He possesses the technical ability, tactical awareness and temperament to succeed at the highest level.

Ready for the next step

A self-confessed admirer of former World No. 1 Fan Zhendong, Abhinandh appears ready to challenge the likes of G. Sathiyan, Harmeet Desai, Manav Thakkar and Manush Shah on the domestic and international circuits, besides testing himself against the world's best paddlers.

If his UTT performance is any indication, he will leave no stone unturned to prime himself for bigger battles, bigger stages and bigger medals.

Test Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Travis Head	853	884
2	Harry Brook	852	898
3	Joe Root	840	932
4	Steve Smith	831	947
5	Temba Bavuma	775	806
6	Kamindu Mendis	744	784
7	Shubman Gill	743	807
8	Rachin Ravindra	740	740
9	Yashasvi Jaiswal	733	858
10	Dinesh Chandimal	713	755

ODI Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Shubman Gill	801	841
2	Daryl Mitchell	794	840
3	Virat Kohli	767	908
4	Rohit Sharma	758	879
5	Ibrahim Zadran	712	756
6	Babar Azam	689	894
7	Harry Tector	679	730
8	Joe Root	674	810
9	Shai Hope	673	782
10	Charith Asalanka	659	705

T20I Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Ishan Kishan	910	916
2	Sahibzada Farhan	848	848
3	Abhishek Sharma	819	931
4	Phil Salt	799	881
5	Pathum Nissanka	751	796
6	Tilak Varma	750	845
7	Jos Buttler	748	794
8	Harry Brook	734	734
9	Mitchell Marsh	706	706
10	Dewald Brevis	702	738

Test Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Jasprit Bumrah	870	908
2	Abir Henry	861	870
3	Mitchell Starc	838	852
4	Pat Cummins	832	914
5	Marco Jansen	825	825
6	Scott Boland	820	820
7	Noman Ali	809	853
8	Kagiso Rabada	807	902
9	Josh Hazlewood	775	864
10	Nathan Lyon	753	812

ODI Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	682	775
2	Abir Ahmed	675	675
3	Jofra Archer	649	682
4	Keshav Maharaj	645	737
5	Mitchell Santner	644	656
6	Maheesh Theekshana	641	680
7	Bernard Scholtz	610	631
8	Shaheen Afridi	604	691
9	Mehidy Hasan	602	722
10	Adil Rashid	599	671

T20I Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	753	828
2	Abir Ahmed	736	757
3	Adil Rashid	710	747
4	Adam Zampa	700	746
5	Nathan Ellis	675	678
6	Corbin Bosch	669	745
7	Wanindu Hasaranga	668	809
8	Mujeeb Ur Rahman	663	757
8	Varun Chakaravathy	663	818
10	Mohammad Nawaz	658	672

BY A WHISKER

Yamini finishes with silver medal in 57kg after a gruelling title clash



PTI

Indian judoka Yamini Mourya missed a gold medal narrowly, losing to England's Acelya Toprak in the women's 57kg final that stretched into Golden Score at the Commonwealth Games on Friday. Toprak, who eventually won on ippon, looked to score heavily by forcing the Indian on to the mat, but Yamini exhibited resilience.

MAKING THE CUT

Indian mixed 4x400m relay team books spot in the final



GETTY IMAGES

The Indian mixed 4x400m relay team qualified for the final after finishing seventh overall in the first-round heat races in the Commonwealth Games on Friday. The quartet of Vishal T.K., Anisa Babu, Rajesh Ramesh and Rashdeep Kaur, in pic., clocked 3:20.98s to end up fourth in Heat 2 and sneak into Saturday's final.

MAKEOVER

Fans go down memory lane as Rohit sports a new look



X@RAVISHASTRI0FC

Rohit Sharma sent cricket fans on a nostalgia trip on Friday after a fresh photograph of the veteran surfaced on social media. Former India head coach Ravi Shastri shared a photo alongside the star opener following a chance encounter in London. The image showed Rohit sporting a neatly trimmed beard.

DOOR IS OPEN

England cricket chief Key refuses to rule out Stokes' return



GETTY IMAGES

England cricket chief Rob Key has left the door open for an international comeback by former Test captain Ben Stokes, who announced his retirement in June. "He hasn't [said anything] but I wouldn't be surprised. Anything's possible with Ben. No [bridges have been burned]... not at all. Not as far as I'm concerned."

Judokas Asmita, Harsh script historic triumph

The former edges out Canada's Quach in a nail-biting contest in the women's 48kg final while the latter pulls off a huge win over Australia's Katz in the men's 60kg gold medal bout

C'WEALTH GAMES

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

Indian judokas added to the country's celebrations by clinching two historic gold medals at the Commonwealth Games at the Scottish Event Campus here on Friday.

Asmita Dey defeated Heidi Quach of Canada 2-1 in the 48kg women's final while Harsh Singh stunned Joshua Katz of Australia, who was the reigning bronze medallist, 10-0 in the men's 60kg summit clash.

Trailing 0-1, Asmita was under pressure as she had received a penalty. Unfazed, the 23-year-old from Belonia, South Tripura, pinned her opponent to level the scores.

After the four-minute regulation time, the contest went into the Golden Score period.

Asmita executed her plans with a decisive attack to score a famous 2-1 win.

Later, Harsh largely controlled the pace of the contest as both judokas went after each other, but the Indian's strategy was better equipped to handle the pressure.

The breakthrough eventually came when Harsh executed a well-timed attack to take a 10-0 lead and he jumped high in the air to celebrate the huge win.

The death of Asmita's



Golden hour: Asmita became the first Indian to win the judo gold before Harsh joined her. GETTY IMAGES Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBdOF> father Arjun Kumar Dey remains etched in her mind so much so that when she came to the mixed zone, a question about him, made her emotional. "My father was very supportive. After his death in 2015, it was difficult for us. Uttar Pradesh Police helped me in getting a job. I would like to thank my coach Yashpal Solanki who trained me at the National Centre of Excellence (Bhopal)".



Lovepreet. GETTY IMAGES

So near yet so far for Lovepreet

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

Holding a 10kg lead in snatch and yet losing the gold medal by a narrow margin is enough to leave any weightlifter shattered.

That was Lovepreet Singh's fate in the men's +110kg super heavyweight competition of the Commonwealth Games at the Scottish Event Campus here on Thursday.

Lovepreet won silver with a total of 388kg behind New Zealand's David Liti (389).

The 29-year-old Indian, a bronze medallist (409kg) at the 2022 Birmingham Games, refused to surrender even as the battle swung dramatically in clean and jerk.

Lovepreet was ultimately denied gold by an athlete with greater experience and pedigree – Liti is a two-time Olympian.

"I should have finished it off in the clean and jerk. It was a costly miss," Lovepreet kept repeating to the mediapersons.

For someone who has had a difficult upbringing in Amritsar, where his father worked as a tailor, Lovepreet has come a long way.

Indian pugilists on the charge



Packing a punch: Jaismine proved too strong for Maselela in the semifinal of the 57kg class. PTI

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

The Indian boxers are on a bull run in the Commonwealth Games at the Scottish Event Campus here, and the national coaches are hoping for a golden harvest.

With 10 pugilists – four men and six women – through to the semifinals and an unprecedented 10 medals already assured, the coaches are hoping the team will surpass its medal haul from the 2022 Birmingham Games by converting as many of those assured podium finishes into gold.

Preeti Pawar set India on its way with a unanimous 5-0 victory over Zambia's Catherine Mwape in the women's 54kg semifinals on Friday. Ankush Panghal then kept the momentum going, producing a masterclass in controlled aggression and crisp mid-range combinations to outclass Canada's Joshua Ofori 5-0 in the men's 80kg bout.

Ofori, who was put on the count twice, had no answer to those Ankush's quick left-right combinations, timed to perfection,

despite arriving in the city with a reputation as a hard puncher.

Reigning World champion Jaismine Lamboria is in a league of her own. As India's head coach Santiago Nieva put it, she is a "clean boxer who doesn't get into a mess easily."

The 24-year-old used her height and reach advantage against Rapelang Maselela of Lesotho to produce a commanding performance in the women's 57kg bout. The referee had to stop the contest in the second round after Maselela struggled to find her range and repeatedly missed.

The women's 70kg clash between Arundhati Choudhary and Wales' Rosie Eccles, however, was a totally different affair. It was a fiercely contested battle from the opening bell, with both refusing to take a step backward.

Jadumani Singh did what was expected of him with a 5-0 win over Philip Pumulo Haoseb of Namibia in the 55kg semifinal. Sakshi Chaudhary beat Canada's Amber-Jane Wall 5-0 to assure herself of at least a silver in 51kg.

Seema hogs the limelight

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

When discussions turn to Indian women's discus throw, they almost invariably begin with Seema Punia, the country's most celebrated thrower and a four-time Commonwealth Games medallist.

But on Thursday, another Seema – bespectacled, unassuming and far less known – stepped into the spotlight.

Seema Kaliramna – a 27-year-old PhD scholar, mother, and an athlete coached by her husband Ravinder Kaliramna – announced herself on the Commonwealth Games stage by winning the bronze medal at the Scotstoun Stadium.

Competing in her maiden Games, Seema produced a best throw of 58.65m to finish third behind Jamaica's Samantha Hall (61.66m) and Canada's Julia Tunks (60.67m), who claimed the gold and silver medals, respectively.

Seema started with a foul, threw 57.32, then came with an effort of 58.65m before again fouling her next three attempts.



Seema. REUTERS

‘This is not permanent, decision on jersey could be changed after review’

HOCKEY

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

Amidst the controversy surrounding the change of Indian hockey teams' jersey, Hockey India (HI) president Dilip Tirkey has made it clear that the decision could well be reversed or changed after review.

"Changes were made earlier too, and this is not something permanent. We will get feedback from players and staff after the World Cup, discuss the pros and cons and make an informed decision.

"Whatever helps the teams to perform better will be done. But any changes – going back to the old uniform or something different – will only be done unanimously and with the full approval of everyone in the Executive Board (EB) and the team," Tirkey told *The Hindu* late



Tirkey. PTI

Friday. The new saffron-coloured jerseys have triggered a backlash from former players and fans alike and threaten to turn it into a political slugfest even as it brought the internal divisions within HI to the fore. Earlier in the day, Tirkey had dissociated himself from the decision and wrote to the Executive Board claiming that he had no knowledge of the same.

"This decision appears to have been taken and implemented without being

placed before the EB for discussion and without my prior knowledge... I have also been asked by the Government of Odisha to provide clarification regarding this matter. I therefore request the concerned HI officials to provide me with a written clarification, outlining the basis of the decision, the process followed and the circumstances under which the change was approved and implemented," he wrote.

Tirkey also wrote to HI Director General Cdr. R.K. Srivastava seeking a detailed response on the same. He, however, admitted in his mail that he had publicly clarified that the change was purely a sporting decision only to ensure the teams' focus remained on preparing for the upcoming World Cup.

In response, Srivastava defended the move while the key argument indicates that the EB was not consulted or informed. "In the

past, the format of jersey, including pattern/colour, has been changed only on the basis of feedback and decision of the players & coaches. Earlier also, there has been no committee or any approval taken from the Executive Board.

"One such recent change was done in November/ December 2022," Srivastava wrote.

Detailing the process of change, he said, "The process involved: Feedback from the national coaching staff, leadership group of players; technical review of visibility and contrast issues; design development with the kit partner; internal clearance through the appropriate officers responsible for high-performance operations and kit management. Extensive consultation took place with the current head coaches, support staff and playing group (including captains and senior athletes of both the teams)".

Yashaswini stretched by Chong

C'WEALTH TT

Amol Karhadkar
NEW DELHI

India's Yashaswini Ghorpade overcame a spirited challenge from Singapore teenager Chong Sian Zi to enter the women's singles pre-quarterfinals at the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships at the Thyagaraj Stadium on Friday.

Fresh from playing a key role in India's team gold medal triumph, the third seed prevailed 4-1, but the scoreline scarcely reflected the quality of resistance offered by the 15-year-old Singaporean.

Chong countered Yashaswini's long-pimpled backhand with impressive composure, refusing to be drawn into errors and matching the Indian in extended rallies. The only one-sided game came in the third, when Yashaswini unleashed a series of forehand winners that left the teenager with few answers. Undeterred, Chong conti-



Battling it out: Yashaswini had to work hard to progress to the pre-quarterfinals. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

nued to trouble the Indian with her fearless shot-making before eventually bowing out.

With the host nation allowed to field 16 paddlers each in the men's and women's singles, the Indians dominated the day's action and secured a majority of berths in the pre-quarterfinals.

Sayali Wani kept India's campaign on track with a hard-fought victory over Malaysia's Ying Ho, while Yashini Sivashankar exited after an encouraging dis-

play against Australia's Constantina Psihogios. The young Indian repeatedly tested the Australian before going down in a closely fought contest.

In men's singles, Payas Jain proved too strong for Malaysia's Choong Javen to move into the last 16. Defensive specialist H. Jeho ended compatriot Mudit Dani's campaign with a clinical victory in an all-Indian encounter while Ronit Bhanja produced an entertaining 4-1 win over Singapore's Ellsworth Le to com-

plete another successful day for the home contingent.

Important results (round of 32): Men: Jash Modi bt Thisas Methkalana (SL) 11-2, 11-4, 11-8, 11-5; Akash Pal bt August Xiao (NZ) 11-9, 11-7, 8-11, 11-6, 11-6; Payas Jain bt Yung Ho Choong (Mas) 11-7, 13-11, 11-6, 11-5; Sanil Shetty bt Eli Ho (NZ) 11-7, 11-8, 11-8; Harmeet Desai bt Xuqi Lin (Aus) 9-11, 11-8, 11-9, 11-6, 11-4; H. Jeho bt Mudit Dani 11-8, 11-3, 11-3, 11-8; Ronit Bhanja bt Ellsworth Le (Sgp) 11-5, 11-7, 9-11, 11-7, 15-13; Manav Thakkar bt Akhyar Ahmed Khalid (Mdv) 11-7, 11-7, 11-6, 11-2.

Women: Yanngzi Liu (Aus) bt Karen Lyne Anak Dick (Mas) 11-4, 11-4, 11-7, 11-2; Swastika Ghosh bt Olivia Huang (CAN) 11-7, 11-2, 11-6, 11-6; Anusha Kutumbale bt Jocelyn Lam (NZ) 10-12, 11-3, 11-4, 11-8, 11-5; Tin-Tin Ho (Eng) bt Kavya Bhatt 6-11, 11-2, 11-4, 11-1, 11-2; Taneesha Kotecha bt Anzhou Han (NZ) 11-4, 11-8, 11-6, 11-7; Ai Xin Tee (Mas) bt Suhana Saini 11-6, 11-5, 8-11, 11-4, 11-6; Nithyashree Mani bt Fiona Ilayi Nie (Can) 11-2, 11-6, 11-5, 13-11; Sayali Wani bt Ying Ho (Mas) 12-10, 13-11, 11-6, 7-11, 11-9; Constantina Psihogios (Aus) Yashini Sivashankar 5-11, 11-3, 11-9, 9-11, 9-11, 19-17; Yashaswini Ghorpade bt Sian Zi Chong (Sgp) 11-8, 11-7, 11-2, 11-13, 12-10.

CM
YK